Tablet Questions (J-14)

1. In section IV, p.6 of the Statement of Objective document (Network Performance), and 6.1.2, systems are required to follow FedRAMP. The system is understood to include the infrastructure and software that comprises the SaaS offering. However, in other RFP sections, only the "infrastructure" is required to follow FedRAMP. Will BOP require the SaaS offering (infrastructure and software) to be FedRAMP? Or, will BOP not follow Federal-wide FedRAMP guidance, and only require that the hosting infrastructure be FedRAMP?

   Response: BOP requires that the infrastructure and software be FedRAMP.

2. For Security and Compliance Documentation Requirement – Does BOP require documentation of only the cloud infrastructure, or the total system/solution as being the infrastructure, software, processes and procedures that comprise SaaS FedRAMP authorization?

   Response: BOP requires total system/solution documentation.

3. If the SaaS provider holds a FedRAMP authorization for their total system/solution (infrastructure, software, etc.), does that negate the need to also provide the other listed documentation such as VPAT, penetration tests, etc.?

   Response: If the SaaS provider has FedRAMP authorization, BOP doesn't need to pen test the infrastructure, but DOJ will pen test the web app (the instance for BOP created in their FedRAMP environment and accessible via a URL). VPAT documentation needs to be provided to ensure that the technology meets the accessibility requirements.

4. On p.71 of the RFP document, H.1 Special Contract Requirements, will BOP remove the phrase "Within 18 months" such that BOP requires LMS FedRAMP authorization already have been achieved at time of award versus 18 months after award? Similarly, will BOP remove 5.A.2. ensuring awarded LMS is FedRAMP authorized at time of award?

   Response: The BOP does not intend to change this language. FedRAMP must be achieved within 18 months of award. Upon contract award the awardee is expected to build a solution in an approved GovCloud space. When the awardee has completed this process, they are then expected to hire an approved 3PAO. BOP's intent is to then sponsor the awardee for their FedRamp certification. While the vendor works to get the FedRamp Certification (to operate in GOV Cloud), BOP will issue an interim 12-month ATO.

5. How does BOP intend fund the tablet purchase and infrastructure build-out? Is this something to be billed to the Bureau, or does the Bureau intend for the vendor to pay for the tablets & infrastructure build-out and build these costs into the services provided to inmates?

Response: The BOP does not intend to fund the tablet purchase or infrastructure build-out. This will be paid by the vendor, and the costs shall be built into the inmate services.

6. How does BOP intend to facilitate the vendor access to Govcloud resources and services? Non-governmental organizations must provide Govt contract number to access Govcloud resources. Will BOP facilitate the tenant subscription on behalf of the vendor, or does BOP expect vendor to directly contract with the Govcloud provider?

   Response: It is the vendor's responsibility to gain access to GovCloud, the BOP will not create a subscription for the vendor.

7. Does BOP intend to designate data stored in this project as CJI/CJIS data?

   Response: No, the BOP does not intend to designate data stored in this project as CJI/CJIS data.

8. The SOO requires 3PAO certification requirement is for the Cloud Provider or for this system's solution provider? What is the timeframe for providing the SSP and SAR to BOP? Will a provisional ATO or ATT be granted while the proposed system is under construction and a SAR is being created?

   Response: The cloud system being proposed needs to have a FedRAMP ATO which requires it to be assessed by the 3PAO. The BOP will be responsible for assessing the controls that are deemed customer responsibility matrix (CRM) by the cloud service provider. The BOP will directly request the ATO package from the FedRAMP PMO. If the vendor is proposing a system that utilizes a FedRAMP authorized cloud system but also has other system components that will be hosted within the FedRAMP environment and/or have components hosted within the BOP environment, an interim ATO will be granted for 18 months for the system to be built/configured. The vendor will be required to complete all ATO requirements within these 18 months.

9. Please provide expected timeline to get ATT and ATO considering the availability of Bureaus' resources for these efforts?

   Response: Upon contract award the awardee is expected to build a solution in an approved GovCloud space. When the awardee has completed this process, they are then expected to hire an approved 3PAO. BOP's intent is to then sponsor the awardee for their FedRamp certification. While the vendor works to get the FedRamp Certification (to operate in GOV Cloud), BOP will issue an interim 12-month ATO.

10. The SOO requires network access to the inmate's bed. How many individual cells (broken down by institution and housing unit) are secured by solid Metal and Steel doors?

    Response: 70-80% of the doors in the BOP are solid metal and steel.

11. The SOO requires MFA using biometrics; which types of biometrics are acceptable for use on inmate tablets?

    Response: The current approved biometric method for inmate MFA authentication is fingerprints.

12. Who will be responsible for biometric enrollment, how will Bureau staff support this enrollment effort at the beginning of the project, an then ongoing when new inmates are admitted?

    Response: The vendor should provide a solution for enrollment of biometrics and issuance of tablet devices.

13. What is the defined process for exceptions for individuals who are unable to satisfy the biometric requirements?

    Response: There are no exceptions to this requirement.

14. The SOO requires ability to locate tablets remotely anywhere in the facilities. Is device tracking be based on last Wi-Fi connection sufficient, or does Bureau want RFID (or similar technology)?

    Response: The FBOP welcomes the vendor's approach to meet this requirement.

15. If RFID (or similar technology is needed), who is responsible for providing the readers, and how many readers will be needed?

    Response: All hardware and infrastructure for this project are the responsibility of the vendor to meet this requirement.

16. Please advise what role BOP intends for Kiosks, especially when the tablets do not need kiosks for activation, updates, etc.

    Response: Kiosks are intended to provide similar but limited functionality (as needed by BOP) as the tablet devices in cases where a tablet is damaged and awaiting a replacement or an inmate is prohibited from being issued a tablet.

17. How many kiosks are needed in each institution/housing unit.

    Response: See SOO 5.2.1, the number is dependent on the programming offered, and occupancy limits of a given housing unit, etc. The kiosks will be located in the housing units of the facilities. Kiosks should be available for approximately 5 per 100 inmates. Approximately 5% of the population per housing unit.

18. How does BOP intend to service failed/damaged kiosks?

Response: It is the vendor's responsibility to service and repair failed or damaged kiosks.

19. Must the WAN use TIC for all outbound network access, including voice phone calls?

    Response: Generally, yes, but the BOP welcomes the vendor solution for this traffic while remaining compliant with FedRAMP requirements.

20. Will BOP allow complexes to share a WAN connection, or does it want each institution in a complex to have its own WAN connection?

    Response: The BOP is open to the vendor's approach to satisfy the requirements of the solicitation.

21. Are hardened plastic enclosures acceptable for tamper proofing AP(s), or are metal enclosures required?

    Response: Generally metal enclosures are used for this purpose, but the requirement is that they be hardened and tamper-proof for the correctional environment.

22. What is the adjudication process if an acceptable location cannot be identified greater than 6 ft away?

    Response: This would have to be evaluated by the BOP on a case-by-case basis during the design and approval phase of the build out.

23. How does BOP intend to avoid channel congestion between existing APs (BOP's and existing vendors) and AP(s) from new vendors?

    Response: To avoid congestion, BOP network engineers will coordinate RF planning and operational coordination between the networks/vendors—especially agreeing on channel usage (and potentially channel widths and transmit power) to minimize co-channel contention. Network engineers will also provide guidance to the designated vendor to ensure vendor-installed AP's meet minimum distance requirements between all installed Access points.

24. Are racks preexisting in said secure communications closets? Please provide locations of each secure closet in each institution.

    Response: While a majority of communication closets have rack space, we cannot provide locations for all secure closets.

25. Please provide list of housing units that have pre-existing connections available to connect to the institution MDF.

    Response: The FBOP does not have direct connections within housing units that a vendor may use to get to the MDF.

26. Are Secure Wireless Backhauls between buildings considered "Wi-Fi Bridging"?

    Response: This scenario does meet the definition of what BOP considers bridging. BOP encourages vendors to provide a solution that does not include back-hauling as this adds additional security and bandwidth congestion concerns associated with backhaul/mesh networks.

27. Will BOP consider private LTE as an alternative to Wi-Fi?

    Response: Yes, private LTE is an acceptable alternative.

28. SOO provides rules about network cabling; if Wi-Fi backhaul is disallowed, does Bureau expect vendor to install new fiber from MDF to the various buildings in the institution. If so, please provide list of housing units by institution that will require new fiber installation?

    Response: BOP will provide the minimum required single-mode fiber connectivity to support the infrastructure at all institutions except for the following locations: Ashland FCI, Ashland SPC, Big Spring FCI, Big Spring SPC, Duluth FPC, Edgefield FCI, Edgefield SPC, La Tuna FCI, La Tuna SPC, Montgomery FPC, Morgantown FPC, Safford FCI, Sandstone FCI, Springfield MCFP, and Yankton FPC. For these locations, the BOP will provide 24-strand single-mode fiber cabling on-site, while the contractor shall provide all labor and any additional materials required to install the fiber necessary to support the infrastructure for this project.

    This amendment does not alter the contractor's responsibility to install all horizontal copper cabling required to support the wireless infrastructure at every institution.

29. The SOO mentions vendor needs to "extend wireless and wired." To minimize duplicating existing available infrastructure (particularly network connections from institution's MDF to other buildings), please list of institutions/housing units provide where existing network infrastructure is available for this project.

    Response: BOP will provide the minimum required single-mode fiber connectivity to support the infrastructure at all institutions except for the following locations: Ashland FCI, Ashland SPC, Big Spring FCI, Big Spring SPC, Duluth FPC, Edgefield FCI, Edgefield SPC, La Tuna FCI, La Tuna SPC, Montgomery FPC, Morgantown FPC, Safford FCI, Sandstone FCI, Springfield MCFP, and Yankton FPC. For these locations, the BOP will provide 24-strand single-mode fiber cabling on-site, while the contractor shall provide all labor and any additional materials required to install the fiber necessary to support the infrastructure for this project.

    This amendment does not alter the contractor's responsibility to install all horizontal copper cabling required to support the wireless infrastructure at every institution.

30. Please provide BOP's rules for installing cables between buildings (existing raceways vs trenching)

    Response: Existing raceways exist, but we cannot verify that they can accept any new wiring. If wiring cannot be installed in existing raceways, due to issues or sizing, new trenching must be conducted.

31. Who is responsible for repair and maintenance of the printers, as well as for the consumables.

    Response: As the equipment is to be vendor-owned and managed, this would be the responsibility of the vendor.

32. Please provide BOP' preferred printer model and number of printers needed for this project.

    Response: The BOP welcomes the vendor's proposal for printers to meet this requirement and they will be evaluated.

33. SOO requires tablets to support phone calls. Do phone calls on tablets need to be managed by the same system that currently manages inmate phone calls made using wall mounted phones?

    Response: No, this should be a vendor proposed system to manage and deliver phone calls.

34. Does BOP intend to keep wall-mounted phones available for inmates to make phones calls. Is the tablet vendor responsible for providing wall-mounted phones. If so, please provide number of wall-mounted handsets by institution and housing unit.

    Response: This is dependent on the vendors' solution; the kiosks could perform this function without the need for the existing wall-mounted phones.

35. Please provide the list of rules that must be imposed on phone calls made using tablets.

    Response: The following are applicable but not limited to…

    - There needs to be a live monitoring capability for FBOP investigative staff.
    - There needs to be the capability for staff who are live monitoring the call to terminate the call if needed.
    - The call should be limited to a particular amount of time (ie: 15 minutes).

- There needs to be a capability for the inmate account to have an overall or maximum limit of minutes to use in a month. Once that limit is met, no further calls can be placed until revalidation.

- Calls can only be placed to numbers that have been approved by staff.

- There should be an AI Translations and Communication monitoring system to provide translations of calls not made in English and link analysis with other BOP intelligence and communication systems.

- There should be the capability to geo fence and restrict call locations for inmates to specific areas within the institution.

- There should be a capability to prevent three-way calls.

- There should be continuous voice identification verification to prevent inmates handing the tablet over to another.

36. How does the Bureau intend to monitor phone calls made on tablets?

    Response: The vendor should provide a solution to facilitate recording and monitoring of phone calls, as required in the SOO 6.1.2.11.

37. Phone call recordings, do these have to be kept at each institution or only stored centrally.

    Response: There should be a central cloud-based system to access/monitor these calls.

38. How does the Bureau intend to assign and handout tablets to inmates?

    Response: The vendor is expected to work with the BOP to enroll and issue tablet devices.

39. When inmate is transferred to another BOP institution, will the tablet move with the inmate?

    Response: Yes, tablets are to be assigned to a specific inmate during the time of their incarceration

40. How does the Bureau intend to collect tablets from inmates at time of release?

    Response: The BOP anticipates this will be completed during inmate discharge, but we welcome suggestions from the vendor on best practices to accomplish this, as all tablets are vendor-owned and managed.

41. Do housing units have enough electrical ports to support each inmate having individual tablet charger?

Response: Individual chargers are not authorized. As stated in the SOO 5.2.2, there are specific requirements for tablet recharging stations.

42. Does Bureau need vendors to provide charging cabinets in each housing unit? If so, please confirm that there is wall space for the same, and number of charging ports required for each institution/housing unit.

    Response: Space will be made available as needed to house and secure the required charging stations for this project.

43. Who is responsible for service and maintenance of the charging cabinets. If vendor, please provide security requirements and protocols for entering institution for such activities and availability of escorts for the same.

    Response: Yes, like the other hardware, it is vendor owned, managed, and maintained. Specific institution procedure may vary.

    Sample Procedures:
    1.1 CONTRACTOR USE OF PREMISES

A. The Contractor shall limit its use of the premise to the work indicated, so as to allow for Government occupancy and use. During the entire construction period, the Contractor shall coordinate use of the premises for construction operations with the FBOP Contracting Officer's Representative (COR).

1. All visitors to the construction site shall register with the FBOP site officials. The Contractor shall not allow employees to have personal visitors on site.

2. The project site will be open to the Contractor from Monday through Friday, with exception of federal holidays, for the duration of the project. The project schedule is to be based on a normal 40-hour work week. The Contractor shall establish a normal work week schedule for the duration of the project. *(Edit work hour descriptions as necessary)*
    a. Work outside the secure perimeter of the institution will be allowed between the hours of 6:30 AM to 4:30 PM. This will allow the Contractor's work force to arrive on-site in the morning and prepare for entering the secure perimeter of the institution. It will also allow the Contractor's workforce to button-up their lay-down/staging area after exiting the secure perimeter at the end of the workday.
    b. Work inside the secure perimeter of the institution will be allowed between the hours of 7:30 AM to 3:00 PM. Work inside the secure perimeter is restricted to the operation of the institution's rear gate. The Contractor's work force will be allowed to enter the rear gate at approximately 7:30 AM each workday. At this time, the FBOP staff will begin personnel and tool security check-in procedures. Once the check-in procedures are completed, the Contractor will be escorted by an FBOP escort to the work area. The rear gate closes at 3:00 PM;

therefore, the Contractor's work force will be escorted back to the rear gate by FBOP staff no later than approximately 2:30 PM, in order to allow enough time for the completion of security check-out procedures prior to exiting the secure perimeter.

3. Contraband: The Contractor shall inform his/her employees that intoxicating beverages, drugs, weapons, etc.., will not be allowed on the site. Introduction of contraband shall be subject to the penalties prescribed by Title 18 USC 1791.

4. Explosives: The use of explosives is absolutely forbidden without written authorization from the FBOP Contracting Officer upon no less than thirty (30) days advance written request.

5. Cell phones, pagers, and radios are not allowed within the secure perimeter.

6. Parking: Parking areas, either on or off-site will be furnished for workmen by the Contractor at a location approved by the FBOP Contracting Officer's Representative (COR).

7. Temporary Office: Any temporary field office used by the Contractor shall be located in an area approved by the FBOP Contracting Officer's Representative (COR).

8. The Contractor shall review his or her site layout plan for staging, stockpiles, etc.., with the FBOP Contracting Officer's Representative (COR). The Contractor shall maintain all staging and construction areas in a neat and orderly fashion.

9. The Contractor shall provide protection of the work against weather, rain, wind, storms, frost, cold, or heat so as to maintain all work, materials, apparatus and fixtures free from injury or damage.

1.2 CONTRACTOR PERSONNEL AND EQUIPMENT SECURITY

A. Contractor employees working at a FBOP facility will be subject to a background investigation after award of the contract. Contractor employees must complete the applicable forms provided by the FBOP Contracting Officer's Representative. Following the investigation, the FBOP will provide the Contractor with a list of employees approved to work at the institution. If a Contractor's employee is not approved, only that fact will be communicated to the Contractor. No additional justification will be released in compliance with Privacy Act requirements.

B. Contractor employees working within the secure perimeter shall wear a clearance badge issued by the institution at all times, and shall be escorted by an institution staff member.

C. Tools brought into the institution's secure perimeter will be inventoried at the beginning and end of each workday by FBOP staff.

1. All tools used by the Contractor working within the secure perimeter shall be under constant supervision. Loss of a tool shall be reported immediately to the escorting FBOP staff.

2. No explosive action tools shall be used on the property at anytime.

3. Materials brought inside the secure perimeter of the institution shall be limited to a one-day supply. Surplus materials not installed on workdays must be moved outside the secure perimeter at the end of the day.

D. Contractor employees working on the FBOP site shall be required to undergo a general institution orientation on responsibilities, procedures and laws governing conduct when working at an FBOP institution. These rules include, but are not limited to the following:

1. Weapons and ammunition of any kind are not allowed on Federal property, including the parking lot.
2. Do not give, or offer to give, anything to an inmate.
3. Do not bring any correspondence into or out of the institution.
4. Do not accept gifts or favors from inmates.
5. Leave personal items locked in your vehicle or secure them at the Contractor's lay-down area.
6. A form of photo ID is required to enter the facility.
7. Revealing clothing is not acceptable attire and work attire is required at all times.
8. Conduct yourself in a responsible, mature manner.
9. Report an unusual action(s) or behavior to FBOP staff.

44. Would the FBOP please provide the current rates for all revenue generating services currently installed (i.e. phone calling, video visits, messaging, streaming services, entertainment, etc.)?

    Response: The BOP is seeking the vendors best pricing for the contract line items in section B of the solicitation. Per Section B.1:

    The vendor shall provide services directly to the Bureau of Prisons (BOP) and shall invoice the BOP monthly for services based on actual usage in accordance with the contract pricing schedule. BOP, as the sole authorized provider for the sale of items to the inmate population, shall apply an administrative markup to applicable items sold.

45. Would the FBOP please provide a copy of the revenue and usage reports for all revenue generating services, covering the last 6-month period for each incumbent communications provider?

    Response: Current estimated annual usage is included in the solicitation for non-entertainment related line items. The FBOP does not currently utilize a streaming based pricing structure for entertainment content.

46. Would the FBOP please provide us with a copy of their current inmate communications agreement, along with any amendments/addendums available?

    Response: The inmate phone system of the Federal Bureau of Prisons is not operated by a single outside contractor; specific components are supported by external providers. The software maintenance is provided by ATG, through its TRUFONE platform, network traffic is provided by Verizon through the Enterprise Infrastructure Solutions provided by GSA. All physical infrastructure-including phones, servers, switches, and fiber-is installed and maintained by Bureau staff.

47. Are there currently any daily or weekly limits applied to remote video visits?

    Response:

    TRUFONE

    1. 510 monthly minutes
    2. 15 minutes between calls - can be adjusted by the facility
    3. SHU inmates are usually two 15-minute calls per day - can be adjusted
    4. $400 limit on TRUFONE account to make calls

    TRULINCS

    1. 15 minutes between TRULINCS session
    2. 20 login attempts
    3. 30 Active Email Contacts
    4. 30 Active Phone Numbers
    5. 30 min staff messages session
    6. 5 Staff messages per day

48. In regard to the Past Performance Questionnaires, are our selected customers who will be providing the evaluations required to email the contact on the last page of the questionnaire directly? Or is the desire for the FBOP to have Vendors only submit those forms as part of our RFP response via email?

    Response: The responses can be sent directly to the email listed on the past performance questionnaire or submitted with the proposal. The questionnaire must be completed prior to proposal submission.

49. We would like to respectfully inquire if the FBOP would consider granting a 7-10 day extension to the RFP submission deadline, if possible? This would allow vendors additional time to assess the released answers to questions and put together their best possible response.

    Response: The FBOP has extended the response deadline to 03/17/2026 at 12 P.M. EST.

50. Will the BOP please provide guidance on what information contractors are required to enter in the “CODE” and “FACILITY” fields located in Section 15A of the "Solicitation, Offer, and Award" form?

    Response: Section 15A is where you enter your company name, address, and in the box marked “code” provide your Commercial and Government Entity (CAGE) code. The vendor is not required to fill-in the “facility code” box.

51. Please provide the average daily population (ADP) for all BOP facilities for the last three months, broken down by month, if possible.

    Response: See included population attachment.

52. Section 5.1 references requirements that must comply with the Federal Bureau of Prisons (BOP) Technical Design Guidelines and applicable BOP Information Technology and Electronics (ITE) standards. In order to develop a compliant technical approach and accurate pricing, clarification is requested regarding facility information availability.

    Specifically, will the BOP:

    - Conduct or permit a contractor-led site survey at the facilities included in scope, or
    - Provide current facility diagrams/blueprints identifying:
        - Inmate housing units included in scope
        - Desired locations of fixed kiosk units within each housing unit
        - Defined housing-unit service access requirements (e.g., individual bed level, cell level, or shared housing-unit level)

    Absent a site survey or the above documentation, it is unclear how offerors are expected to validate infrastructure requirements, device placement, network connectivity, power availability, and compliance with the referenced BOP Technical Design Guidelines and BOP ITE standards.

    Please confirm whether a site survey will be conducted or authorized, or whether the BOP will provide the referenced facility documentation necessary to support compliance with section 5.1.

    Response: The BOP is offering a site visit at Butner (2/18, 2/19) for up to three vendor representatives.

53. The current proposal submission deadline is Thursday, February 5, at 2:00 p.m., and the refer to toine to submit questions related to the RFP is Tuesday, January 27. However, the RFP does not specify the date and time when responses to contractor questions will be posted. Will the BOP please provide the anticipated date and time for posting responses to contractor questions? Additionally, because the responses will contain critical information that will directly impact the structure and content of contractor proposals, will the BOP

please consider allowing a minimum of fifteen (15) business days from the date all question responses are posted before the final proposal submission deadline? This extension would ensure contractors have adequate time to review, analyze, and incorporate the BOP's responses into their proposals.

Response: The FBOP has extended the response deadline to 03/17/2026 at 12 P.M. EST.

54. Section B – Supplies or Services and Prices/Costs, line item #11, instructs contractors to "provide all proposed service levels and/or tiered rates for this category." However, the pricing table provided in Section B does not include a designated field or space to enter this information. Please clarify where contractors should include the required service level and/or tiered rate details.

    Response: The FBOP's intent for Contract Line Item Number (CLIN) 0011 and related CLIN's for subsequent periods of performance is to obtain a single price for a 30-day pass. The referenced language was included erroneously and has been removed.

55. Section B – Supplies or Services and Prices/Costs, line item #30, instructs contractors to "provide detail of what services are included in bundled Subscription." However, the pricing table provided in Section B does not include a designated field or space to enter this information. Please clarify where contractors should include the required bundled Subscription details.

    Response: The FBOP's intent for CLIN 0030 and related CLIN's for subsequent periods of performance is to obtain a single price for the bundled offering. The referenced language requests offerors to provide a detailed listing of what services are offered at a single bundled price.

56. To enable vendors to submit their best and most accurate proposals, it is essential to have access to historical pricing, usage, revenue, and operational information related to the current inmate communication services. Accordingly, will the BOP please provide the following information regarding its existing External Electronic Mail Messaging platform?:

    a. The name of the current messaging platform service provider

       Response: TRULINCS, ATG

    b. The types of hardware devices available to inmates for accessing the messaging platform

       Response: Typical inmate messaging system consists of a secure computer workstation-including monitor, keyboard, and mouse-configured without access to the external internet.

c. The current price charged to an inmate to send or receive a single text-based message

Response: The BOP is seeking the vendors best pricing for the contract line items in section B of the solicitation. Per Section B.1:

The vendor shall provide services directly to the Bureau of Prisons (BOP) and shall invoice the BOP monthly for services based on actual usage in accordance with the contract pricing schedule. BOP, as the sole authorized provider for the sale of items to the inmate population, shall apply an administrative markup to applicable items sold.

d. The current price charged to an inmate to receive a digital photo attachment via the messaging platform

Response: This service is not currently provided.

e. The actual total number of text-based electronic messages sent and received during calendar year 2025, or alternatively, an explanation of the methodology used to calculate the estimated annual quantity of 88,405,833 messages included in the pricing table located in Section B – Supplies or Services and Prices/Costs, line item #2

Response: The figures shown in Section B represent approximate annual usage, based on the actual number of messages sent and received over a one-year period.

f. The total amount of revenue generated from inmate and public users of the messaging platform during calendar year 2025

Response: The BOP is seeking the vendors best pricing for the contract line items in section B of the solicitation. Per Section B.1:

The vendor shall provide services directly to the Bureau of Prisons (BOP) and shall invoice the BOP monthly for services based on actual usage in accordance with the contract pricing schedule. BOP, as the sole authorized provider for the sale of items to the inmate population, shall apply an administrative markup to applicable items sold.

57. To enable vendors to submit their best and most accurate proposals, it is essential to have access to historical pricing, usage, revenue, and operational information related to the current inmate communication services. Accordingly, will the BOP please provide the following information regarding its existing Video Visitation System (VVS) platform?:

a. The name of the current VVS platform service provider

Response: Advanced Technologies Group (ATG)

b. The types of hardware devices available for inmate use of the VVS platform

Response: Typical inmate video-service system consisting of a ruggedized tamper-resistant video kiosk.

c. The total number of "audio only" visitation telephone handsets installed at all BOP facilities

Response: N/A

d. The current price per minute charged to an inmate or public user for participation in a remote social video visitation session

Response: The BOP is seeking the vendors best pricing for the contract line items in section B of the solicitation. Per Section B.1:

The vendor shall provide services directly to the Bureau of Prisons (BOP) and shall invoice the BOP monthly for services based on actual usage in accordance with the contract pricing schedule. BOP, as the sole authorized provider for the sale of items to the inmate population, shall apply an administrative markup to applicable items sold.

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e. The current price per minute charged to an inmate or attorney for participation in a remote privileged video visitation session

Response: N/A

f. The actual total number of social and privileged video visitation session minutes used during calendar year 2025, or alternatively, an explanation of the methodology used to calculate the estimated annual quantity of 30,865,050 minutes referenced in Section B – Supplies or Services and Prices/Costs, line item #3

Response: The figures shown in Section B represent approximate usage based on a one-year period. However, the video service is currently limited only to institutions that house females, and the number provided reflects projected usage if the service is expanded across all institutions.

g. The total amount of revenue generated from use of the VVS platform during calendar year 2025

Response: The BOP is seeking the vendors best pricing for the contract line items in section B of the solicitation. Per Section B.1:

The vendor shall provide services directly to the Bureau of Prisons (BOP) and shall invoice the BOP monthly for services based on actual usage in accordance with the contract pricing schedule. BOP, as the sole authorized provider for the sale of items to the inmate population, shall apply an administrative markup to applicable items sold.

h. A description of the VVS platform's artificial intelligence (AI), natural language processing (NLP), and advanced analytics capabilities used to transcribe, translate, and analyze inmate communications, including how these capabilities correlate video communications with other available inmate communication records and intelligence data sources"

Response: AI is not currently being utilized.

58. To enable vendors to submit their best and most accurate proposals, it is essential to have access to historical pricing, usage, revenue, and operational information related to the current inmate communication services. Accordingly, will the BOP please provide the following information regarding its existing Inmate Telephone System (ITS) platform?:

a. The name of the current ITS platform service provider

Response: The inmate phone system of the Federal Bureau of Prisons is not operated by a single outside contractor; specific components are supported by external providers. The software maintenance is provided by ATG, through its TRUFONE platform, network traffic is provided by Verizon through the Enterprise Infrastructure Solutions provided by GSA. All physical infrastructure-including phones, servers, switches, and fiber-is installed and maintained by Bureau staff.

b. The total number of wall-mounted inmate telephone stations that support outgoing calls through the Public Switched Telephone Network (PSTN) installed across all BOP facilities

Response: BOP currently has 8,141 active inmate phones.

c. The total number of cart-mounted or portable inmate telephone stations that support outgoing calls through the Public Switched Telephone Network (PSTN) available at all BOP facilities

Response: Telephone quantities (cart mounted) are not fixed and are provided based on the individual facility requests, operational needs, and housing configuration and approved capacity requirements.

d. The current price per minute charged to an inmate or public user for local, interstate, and international telephone calls

Response: The BOP is seeking the vendors best pricing for the contract line items in section B of the solicitation. Per Section B.1:

The vendor shall provide services directly to the Bureau of Prisons (BOP) and shall invoice the BOP monthly for services based on actual usage in accordance with the contract pricing schedule. BOP, as the sole authorized provider for the sale of items to the inmate population, shall apply an administrative markup to applicable items sold.

e. The current price per minute charged to an inmate or attorney for local and interstate telephone calls

Response: Answered in section d.

f. The actual total number of telephone call minutes used during calendar year 2025, or alternatively, an explanation of the methodology used to calculate the estimated annual quantity of 400,000,000 minutes referenced in Section B – Supplies or Services and Prices/Costs, line item #4

Response: The figures shown in Section B represent approximate annual usage, based on the actual number of minutes used over a one-year period.

g. The total amount of revenue generated from use of the ITS platform during calendar year 2025

Response: The BOP is seeking the vendors best pricing for the contract line items in section B of the solicitation. Per Section B.1:

The vendor shall provide services directly to the Bureau of Prisons (BOP) and shall invoice the BOP monthly for services based on actual usage in accordance with the contract pricing schedule. BOP, as the sole authorized provider for the sale of items to the inmate population, shall apply an administrative markup to applicable items sold.

h. A description of the ITS platform's artificial intelligence (AI), natural language processing (NLP), and advanced analytics capabilities used to transcribe, translate, and analyze inmate communications, including how these capabilities correlate telephone communications with other available inmate communication records and intelligence data sources"

Response: AI is currently not provided.

59. Will the BOP please provide the following information regarding the printing services required:

    a. Scope of Printing Services: Section B – Supplies or Services and Prices/Costs, line item #5 (Printing – Per Page), references an estimated annual quantity of 4,369,284 pages. Additionally, please clarify which type of materials inmates will be allowed to print (e.g., electronic messages, photos, documents, digital mail, educational materials)?

       Response: The inmates will be able to print legal document, electronic messages, mailing labels, account statements / transactions, BP –199, and Contact List.

    b. Current Hardware and Consumables: The total number of printer stations that support print jobs initiated by inmates installed across all BOP facilities. Additionally, please clarify whether contractors are responsible for providing and maintaining all printers, consumables (paper, toner), and related infrastructure

       Response: Printer maintenance is currently performed by BOP staff. Upon award of the contract, all printer equipment and maintenance services will be provided by the successful contractor. There are approximately 150 print stations. This amount varies based on institutional needs.

    c. Color vs. Black-and-White Printing: Please clarify whether the printing requirement is limited to black-and-white output or if color printing is required. If color printing is required, will separate pricing be permitted or should it be included in the per-page rate?

       Response: Black and White.

    d. Single-Sided vs. Double-Sided Printing: Will printed pages be required to be single-sided only, or may duplex (double-sided) printing be used? If duplex printing is permitted, how should contractors account for page counts and pricing?

       Response: Single Sided

    e. Paper Size and Format: Please confirm the required paper size(s) (e.g., 8.5"" x 11"", legal).

       Response: 8.5” x 11”

    f. Current Process: Please detail the current process in which an inmate print jobs are initiated, processed and delivered?

       Response: Inmates mark messages for printing within the inmate messaging service and access centrally located print stations to produce the document.

g. Historical Usage Data: Will the BOP provide historical printing volume data (e.g., monthly totals for calendar year 2024 or 2025) to support more accurate pricing assumptions?"

Response: The figures shown in Section B represent approximate annual usage, based on the actual number of printing jobs over a one-year period.

60. Will the BOP please identify the current commissary service provider(s) used across its institutions, including whether a single vendor or multiple regional vendors are in place? Additionally, please provide the telephone number and email address of the primary point of contact for each provider as well as the GovCloud environment the service(s) are currently hosted in.

Response: The BOP does not rely on a centralized commissary service provider. Instead, each institution independently procures commissary goods from multiple vendors. Major vendors are Keefe, Union Supply, and Athletic Style.

61. Will the BOP please detail how inmate commissary is ordered today?

Response: A pre-printed commissary list is obtained by the purchaser. The purchaser will fill out the form to include name and registration number. The purchaser will select the items and quantity that they wish to purchase on the form. The form is submitted to commissary staff; the items are collected and then sold to the purchaser.

62. Please identify the current inmate financial services platform that the commissary ordering system must interface with, including vendor name, system type, supported integration methods (e.g., API, SFTP, flat file, web services) and what GovCloud environment the services are currently hosted in.

Response: The inmate service platform is TRUFACS and managed by Advanced Technologies Group (ATG). The integration method will be defined jointly by service provider and the selected vendor. GovCloud is not utilized.

63. Will the BOP please respond to the following clarification questions regarding Statement of Objectives (SOO), section "5.2.1.2 Inmate Use Kiosks"?:

a. Minimum Kiosk Quantity Requirement: Section 5.2.1.2 requires the vendor to provide kiosks but does not specify a minimum quantity per institution or housing unit. Will the BOP please define the minimum required number of kiosks (e.g., per facility, per housing unit, or per inmate population) to ensure consistent vendor pricing and evaluation?

Response: Kiosks should be available for approximately five (5) per 100 inmates. Approximately 5% of the population per housing unit.

b. Definition of "Adequate to Serve the Population": The RFP states that the number of kiosks must be "adequate to serve the population, minimizing wait times and potential conflicts," but no performance standard is provided. Will the BOP please specify measurable criteria (e.g., kiosk-to-inmate ratio, maximum wait time, or usage concurrency assumptions) that vendors should use to determine adequacy?

   Response: Kiosks should be available for approximately five (5) per 100 inmates. Approximately 5% of the population per housing unit.

c. Service Scope Impact on Kiosk Quantity: The RFP indicates that kiosk quantity will vary based on the services offered (e.g., messaging, law library access, commissary orders). Will the BOP please clarify which services are required to be accessible via kiosks versus those that may be provided exclusively through tablets or other devices?

   Response: Kiosks are intended to provide similar but limited functionality (as needed by BOP) as the tablet devices in cases where a tablet is damaged and awaiting a replacement or an inmate is prohibited from being issued a tablet.

d. Evaluation Consistency: Given that kiosk quantities are dependent on vendor-specific service offerings, how will the BOP ensure proposals are evaluated on an equal and comparable basis when vendors may propose materially different kiosk deployment models?

   Response: Kiosks will be evaluated based on the requirements laid out in the SOO. Physical security requirements, technical requirements, and the ability to perform the required services that the tablet is required to do.

e. Facility Variability: Will kiosk deployment requirements vary by facility type (e.g., high-density, low-density, administrative, medical, or special housing), and if so, will facility-level population and housing configuration data be provided to support accurate sizing?

   Response: Kiosk deployment will vary based on inmate population and housing unit size.

f. Existing Infrastructure: Are there existing kiosks currently deployed at any BOP facilities, and if so, may vendors leverage existing hardware, or must all kiosks be newly provided by the awarded contractor?

   Response: Kiosks are not currently deployed.

64. Will the BOP please respond to the following clarification questions regarding the contract award date and implementation timeline?

a. Tentative Contract Award Date: Will the BOP please provide the anticipated or target contract award date for this solicitation?

   Response: FBOP anticipates award within 30 days of the proposal submission.

b. Notice to Proceed (NTP): Please clarify when the Notice to Proceed (NTP) is expected to be issued following contract award.

   Response: FBOP intends to issue the NTP within 180 days of the award, upon the Vendor obtaining proper background clearance, interim ATO, and approval of the proposed implementation plan.

c. Implementation Start Date: Does the BOP expect implementation activities to begin immediately upon contract award, upon NTP issuance, or upon completion of other prerequisites (e.g., security clearances, facility access approvals)?

   Response: FBOP intends to issue the NTP within 180 days of the award, upon the Vendor obtaining proper background clearance, interim ATO, and approval of the proposed implementation plan. Implementation Start Date and Base Period of Performance will commence upon issuance of NTP.

d. Required Implementation Timeline: The RFP references required implementation timelines but does not specify a definitive start date. Will the BOP please confirm how the implementation timeline will be measured (e.g., from award date, NTP date, or another milestone)?

   Response: From NTP.

e. Phased vs. Nationwide Deployment: Will implementation be required to occur simultaneously across all BOP institutions, or will the BOP permit a phased rollout by region, facility type, or population size?

   Response: The vendor is responsible for submitting the implementation plan in accordance with the SOO.

f. Facility Readiness Dependencies: Please clarify whether implementation timelines are contingent upon facility readiness factors such as network availability, power, space, and security approvals, and how delays outside the vendor's control will be handled.

   Response: The BOP will work with the vendor during implementation. The vendor will not be responsible for BOP delays.

g. Security and Clearance Lead Times: Will the BOP provide estimated timelines for required background checks, security clearances, and facility access approvals that may impact implementation scheduling?

Response: It should take no more than 30 days from the time we receive a completed packet, fingerprints, and drug test. If there are follow-up questions or documentation that was not completed correctly it could extend the time.

h. Data Migration and Integration Milestones: Are there required deadlines or sequencing requirements for data migration, system integrations, and acceptance testing that vendors must meet within the implementation period?

Response: The time frame will differ based on current contract SLA's the BOP has with other vendors for data migration or system integrations.

i. Acceptance and Go-Live Criteria: Please clarify the criteria that will be used to determine when implementation is considered complete and the system is deemed operational

Response: All required approvals, assessments, applications and integrations are available for inmate use.

j. Final Completion Deadline: Please confirm whether there is a mandatory final completion date for full nationwide implementation and whether extensions may be granted based on mutually agreed-upon conditions."

Response: The offeror is responsible for submitting the implementation schedule.

65. Will the BOP please provide responses to the following clarification questions regarding the Statement of Objectives (SOO), section "5.2.3. Networking Equipment"?:

a. Existing Wireless Infrastructure: Will the BOP please identify the current wireless network infrastructure deployed at its facilities (e.g., vendor(s), wireless standards, frequency bands, controller-based vs. cloud-managed)?

Response: BOP currently utilizes Cisco Wi-Fi access points utilizing 802.11 ax and 802.11 ac standards. BOP uses Controller based management.

To avoid congestion, BOP network engineers will coordinate RF planning and operational coordination between the networks/vendors—especially agreeing on channel usage (and potentially channel widths and transmit power) to minimize co-channel contention. Network engineers will also provide guidance to the designated vendor to ensure vendor-installed AP's meet minimum distance requirements between all installed Access points.

b. Facility Variability: Do wireless network architectures vary by institution, and if so, will facility-specific wireless diagrams or standards be provided to support accurate design and pricing?

Response: The BOP does not have diagrams available to release.

c. Frequency Band Usage: Please clarify which frequency bands are currently in use by BOP (e.g., 2.4 GHz, 5 GHz, 6 GHz) and which bands vendors are permitted to use for inmate-facing devices and kiosks.

   Response: BOP currently uses 2.4 and 5 Ghz. Vendors are permitted to utilize any 802.11ac or newer standards.

d. Interference Management Requirements: Are there specific RF coexistence, interference mitigation, or channel planning requirements that vendors must meet to ensure compatibility with existing and future BOP wireless systems?

   Response: To avoid congestion, BOP network engineers will coordinate RF planning and operational coordination between the networks/vendors—especially agreeing on channel usage (and potentially channel widths and transmit power) to minimize co-channel contention. Network engineers will also provide guidance to the designated vendor to ensure vendor-installed AP's meet minimum distance requirements between all installed Access points

e. Future Wireless Deployments: Please describe any planned or anticipated future BOP wireless deployments (e.g., Wi-Fi 6/6E/7 upgrades, public safety wireless systems, staff mobility networks) that vendors must account for in their designs.

   Response: BOP continues to deploy access points throughout each facility as funding and staffing permits.

66. Please provide a copy of all current BOP contracts and amendments pertaining to all services (e.g. Inmate Telephone System (ITS), Video Visitation System (VVS), Tablet program, Inmate Trust/Banking/Commissary Account Services, Electronic Medical Records, Telehealth, etc.) under this RFP.

    Response: The BOP will add SOWs for the available services to the solicitation posting on SAM.gov.

67. Will the BOP please respond to the following clarification questions regarding Statement of Objectives (SOO), section "6.1.3.1. Atlas Application"?:

    a. Licensing and Access Model: Will the BOP provide licenses for The Change Companies' Atlas application, or is the vendor required to procure, license, and include Atlas access as part of its proposed solution?

       Response: With other DOCs, The Change Companies contract's directly with the agency for Atlas licensing. The agency pays The Change Companies directly, and the tablet vendor enables Atlas on approved devices and facilities as part of the broader tablet deployment. Atlas is not typically procured or resold by the tablet vendor unless the agency explicitly prefers that structure.

b. Hosting and Architecture: Please clarify whether the Atlas application is required to be hosted by the vendor, by BOP, or directly by The Change Companies, and how hosting responsibilities impact integration and security requirements.

   Response: Atlas is hosted and operated by The Change Companies as a cloud-based application. In tablet deployments, Atlas operates as a content application accessed through the tablet platform and within the tablet provider's security and governance controls. Atlas does not require BOP to host or operate the application directly. The Change Companies work with the vendor for the integration and security requirements to ensure they are met.

c. Integration Requirements: Will the BOP provide integration specifications or APIs for connecting the Atlas application with other BOP systems (e.g., inmate management systems, learning management systems, case management systems)?

   Response: Atlas does not require integrations with BOP systems (e.g., inmate management, case management, or learning management systems) to function. Atlas relies solely on the tablet platform for user authentication and encrypted basic identifiers so that inmates can seamlessly access Atlas from their tablets without additional system connectivity. They will work with the vendor to ensure the agency's requirements are met.

d. Risk-Based Notifications: Please define what constitutes "risk-based behavior and targeted indicators" and clarify whether the logic for generating alerts is provided by Atlas, BOP, or must be configured by the vendor.

   Response: In Atlas, "risk-based behavior and targeted indicators" refer to a set of predefined, clinically grounded "flags" surfaced within the application to support staff follow-up. Atlas classifies flags into (1) red indicators for potential safety risks (e.g., potential intent to self-harm or harm others, current psychotic symptoms, sexual coercion/assault, threats/bullying, or other actionable safety/security concerns), and (2) yellow indicators for routine check-ins (e.g., nonsensical responses, responses that are clearly unrelated or indicate disengagement). The baseline flagging logic is provided by Atlas and can be aligned to BOP preferences, does not require configuration by the tablet vendor, and does not involve integrations with BOP systems.

e. Content Scope and Updates: Will the Atlas content library (journaling, workbooks, educational, mental health, and spirituality programming) be standardized across all BOP facilities, and how will content updates be managed during the contract term?

   Response: It would be standardized across all BOP facilities; however, the women's specific learning would not be utilized at the male facilities and vice versa. We were able to get a list of currently available materials on Atlas. During

the contract term, updates to Atlas content or functionality are typically managed through routine application updates coordinated with the tablet provider and subject to agency approval, without requiring contract modifications for standard maintenance or enhancements. Any material changes to scope, pricing, or deployment would be addressed through the appropriate contractual amendment process in coordination with the BOP.

f. Evidence-Based Program Definition: Please clarify which evidence-based recidivism reduction programs must be supported and whether the vendor is responsible for validating program alignment with BOP standards.

   Response: Education: Healthy Minds and Bodies (PA—requesting consideration as EBRR); Wellness Inside and Out (EBRR); Women Aging Well (PA) WASP: Foundation (EBRR); Women's Basic Financial Literacy (EBRR); Women's Career Exploration (EBRR); Women's Career Skills (EBRR); Women's Life Skills (EBRR); Women's Sexual Safety (EBRR); Family Programming Series (EBRR); A Healthier Me (PA); Change Plan (PA); Women's Aging Well (PA); Reflections (PA); Women's Relationships II (PA); Redefining the Mission (PA); Veterans' Career Exploration (PA) Chaplaincy: Life Connections Program (EBRR), Threshold (EBRR), Faith-Based Conflict Management (EBRR) PSB: RDAP series (EBRR), Non-residential Drug Treatment series (EBRR), Drug Education (PA), BRAVE (EBRR), Challenge (EBRR), Step Down (EBRR), Skills (EBRR), Life Skills Labs (EBRR), Sex Offender Treatment Program series (EBRR); Anger Management (EBRR); Criminal Thinking (EBRR); Emotional Self-Regulation (EBRR); Resolve (EBRR); Trauma in Life (PA)/Traumatic Stress and Resilience (PA); MAT (EBRR); Basic Cognitions (EBRR).

g. Virtual Group Activities: Please provide details regarding BOP-hosted or moderated virtual group activities, including required technologies, session sizes, scheduling, and moderation controls.

   Response: The capability to assign inmates to a private/secure "virtual room," which would allow the facilitation of individual and/or group therapy sessions. Additionally, there will likely be instances when institutions are virtually facilitating multiple groups at the same time. Therefore, we will require the capability for multiple "virtual rooms" to be operational simultaneously.

h. Pricing: Section B - Supplies or Services and Prices/Costs, does not include a line item for a vendor to list the price for the provisioning of the "Atlas Application." Will the BOP please advise where vendors are to provide price information regarding the "Atlas Application"?"

   Response: Because Atlas is typically licensed directly by the agency rather than procured by the tablet vendor, pricing for Atlas is not usually included as a line item in the tablet vendor's pricing schedule. Tablet vendors may reference Atlas

as an available content application, while Atlas licensing is addressed separately between the agency and The Change Companies.

68. Will the BOP please respond to the following clarification questions regarding Statement of Objectives (SOO), section "6.1.3.2. Telemedicine Video Visits"?:

    a. Current Telemedicine Video Visit Services: Please identify the BOP Telemedicine Video Visit services currently utilized by the BOP, including vendor name(s) and versions.

       Response: BOP does not utilize a telehealth specific platform currently. All video communications for telehealth presently utilize the Cisco Webex platform and internal video conferencing devices to connect to public telehealth providers, using their preferred internet connected device.

    b. EHR System Identification: Please identify the BOP Electronic Health Record (EHR) system(s) with which the solution must integrate, including vendor name(s) and version(s).

       Response: BOP uses the Bureau Electronic Medical Record (BEMR) provided by Advanced Technologies Group (ATG). However, EHR integration is not a critical requirement for tablet-based telehealth. The primary need is to support the video visit from the patient side with the provider on the other end.

    c. Type of Information Exchanged with EHR: Please specify what "designated information" the system must receive from the EHR (e.g., appointment confirmation, inmate identifiers, provider details, clinical notes, visit metadata).

       Response: BOP's current EHR (BEMR) doesn't support information exchange currently. Therefore, that's not a critical need from inmate's tablets in order to support telehealth.

    d. Recording and Retention Policy: Please clarify whether medical video visits are permitted to be recorded, and if so, what retention, access, and audit requirements apply."

       Response: No, medical video visits should not be recorded or persisted in any means.

69. Will the BOP please provide responses to the following clarification questions regarding section B - Supplies or Services and Prices/Costs, line item #42, "Inmate Trust/Banking/Commissary Account Services"?:

    a. Scope of Ancillary Services: Please clarify which specific services are included under "Inmate Trust/Banking/Commissary Account Services" (e.g., trust

accounting, deposits, withdrawals, debit cards, release cards, commissary settlement, refunds).

Response: The system manages the full lifecycle of inmate accounts, including account establishment upon intake, ongoing transaction processing, balance tracking, reconciliation of deposits, withdrawals, transfers, commissary activity, and account closure upon inmate release or transfer.

b. Award Determination: The RFP states that this pricing request is ancillary and may not be awarded. Will the BOP please clarify under what conditions this line item would be awarded versus excluded from the final contract?

   Response: Some of the line items are listed as ancillary. The intent is to have pricing for the services if the BOP decided to implement at a later time. Upon award these line items will not be funded.

c. Evaluation Impact: If these services are not awarded, will pricing and technical responses for this line item be excluded from proposal evaluation and scoring?

   Response: Ancillary items are not required and will not be evaluated for price or technical scoring.

d. Mandatory vs. Optional Proposal Response: Are vendors required to submit pricing and technical details for this ancillary line item even if the BOP elects not to award this portion of the scope?

   Response: No, a response is not required for ancillary line items.

e. Current Service Provider(s): Will the BOP identify the current provider(s) of inmate trust, banking, and commissary account services, including whether services are centralized or vary by institution?"

   Response: Advanced Technologies Group (ATG).

70. The Statement of Objectives (SOO), section "6.1.2.11. Inmate Telephone System," states, "The ITS systems must be capable of clearly identifying and differentiating between inmate-paid calls and calls provided to inmates at no cost as part of incentive or administrative programs."

    Will the BOP please provide details regarding the incentive or administrative programs currently in place in which inmates are provided with calls at no cost. Please include the total number of "no cost" calls minutes provided to inmates in calendar year 2025."

    Response: The Vendor may bill the FBOP for actual minutes used.

71. Will the BOP please provide responses to the following clarification questions regarding RFP section B - Supplies or Services and Prices/Costs, line items #35, #41, #42, #43, #44, #45 and #46:

    a. Award Determination: The RFP states that this pricing request is for these line items are ancillary and may not be awarded. Will the BOP please clarify under what conditions these line items would be awarded versus excluded from the final contract?

       Response: Some of the line items are listed as ancillary. The intent is to have pricing for the services if the BOP decided to implement at a later time. Upon initial award, these line items will not be funded.

    b. Evaluation Impact: If these services are not awarded, will pricing and technical responses for this line item be excluded from proposal evaluation and scoring?

       Response: Ancillary items are not required and will not be evaluated for price or technical scoring.

    c. Mandatory vs. Optional Proposal Response: Are vendors required to submit pricing and technical details for all ancillary line items even if the BOP elects not to award this portion of the scope?"

       Response: Ancillary items are not required and will not be evaluated for price or technical scoring.

72. Will the BOP please identify the current Inmate/Offender Management System (OMS) provider(s) used across its institutions, including whether a single vendor or multiple regional vendors are in place? Additionally, please provide the telephone number and email address of the primary point of contact for each OMS provider as well as the GovCloud environment the service(s) are currently hosted in.

    Response: BOP utilizes an internally developed application called SENTRY. There is no vendor POC information for this system and the tablet initiative will not be connected to the system.

73. The Business Management Questionnaire requires vendors to "(b) list the last three contracts awarded to your firm which are of a related nature." Will the BOP please clarify whether this should include contracts for which a notice of award has been issued by the procuring agency, or only contracts that have been fully executed by both parties?

    Response: Please provide only contracts that have been fully executed by both parties.

74. Will the BOP please provide respond to the following clarification questions regarding Statement of Objectives (SOO), section "2. Scope":

a. Please define “inside recreation areas” and “outside recreation areas” as used in the SOO.

Response: There are no specific inside or outside areas, but the intent is to provide coverage to institution indoor recreational areas.

b. Please define “bed level” for the housing units. Does “bed level” refer to the housing unit as a whole, or the individual cells within the housing unit?"

Response: Bed level refers to the individual cell within the housing unit as well as the housing unit common areas.

75. Statement of Objectives (SOO), section “6.4 Performance Objectives (Required Results),” states that the solution shall provide “AI-enabled insight outcomes,” including advanced analytical capabilities such as pattern recognition, behavioral anomaly detection, multilingual monitoring, and cross-domain trend analysis, with all AI outputs remaining advisory, explainable, and subject to staff review.” However, section B – Supplies or Services and Prices/Costs, line item #35, Artificial Intelligence Security Features, indicates that this pricing request is ancillary and may not be awarded as part of this requirement.

Will the BOP please clarify whether the AI-enabled capabilities described in section 6.4 are mandatory baseline requirements for all vendors, or whether they are optional features associated only with line item #35? Additionally, if these capabilities are mandatory, please clarify how vendors should price and include them given that the corresponding line item is identified as ancillary."

Response: This is optional and not part of the award evaluation. Please include costs, if any associated within CLIN 0035, and subsequent periods of performance.

76. On December 5, 2025, the Federal Communications Commission (FCC) published a Notice of Proposed Rulemaking on Permanent Rates to the Federal Register (90 RF 56155). This Notice finalizes permanent rate caps for both Incarcerated Persons Communication System (IPCS) audio and video communications and reiterates the prohibition of IPCS providers from paying commissions to agencies on revenue derived from these services. However, agencies are allowed to recover a $0.02 per-minute rate additive to cover reasonable administrative, maintenance, and monitoring costs associated with service provision. All IPCS providers and correctional agencies must implement all rules identified in the Notice by April 6, 2026. For complete notice details, please visit: https://www.govinfo.gov/content/pkg/FR-2025-12-05/pdf/2025-22130.pdf.

Will the BOP please advise if it is your intent to receive the $0.02 per-minute rate additive for inmate telephone and/or remote video visitation services provided? If so, should vendors include the $0.02 per-minute rate additive into the “Unit Price” associated with line item #3 and #4 on section B – Supplies or Services and Prices/Costs?"

Response: The BOP is seeking the vendors best pricing for the contract line items in section B of the solicitation. Per Section B.1:

The vendor shall provide services directly to the Bureau of Prisons (BOP) and shall invoice the BOP monthly for services based on actual usage in accordance with the contract pricing schedule. BOP, as the sole authorized provider for the sale of items to the inmate population, shall apply an administrative markup to applicable items sold.

77. Will the BOP please advise if it is your intent to receive any type of renumeration/commission on revenues derived from use of inmate services that are not regulated by the FCC such as: External Electronic Mail (line item #2); Printing Per Page (line item #5); Music Subscription Services (line item #6, #7, #8, #9, #10 & #11); Movies and Television Subscription Services (line item #12, #13, #14, #15, #16, & #17); Games Subscription Services (line item #18, #19, #20, #21, #22, #23); Podcast Subscription Services (line item #24, #25, #26, #27, #28 & #29); Bundled Subscription Services (line item #30, #31, #32, #33, & #34) and Books/Magazines (line item #36)? If so, where should vendors detail their renumeration/commission offering for these items within their proposal?

    Response: The BOP is seeking the vendors best pricing for the contract line items in section B of the solicitation. Per Section B.1:

    The vendor shall provide services directly to the Bureau of Prisons (BOP) and shall invoice the BOP monthly for services based on actual usage in accordance with the contract pricing schedule. BOP, as the sole authorized provider for the sale of items to the inmate population, shall apply an administrative markup to applicable items sold.

78. The Statement of Objectives (SOO), section "6.1.2.6 Social Visiting," states: "Visitation software is designed to automatically terminate sessions if any display of nudity, sexual behavior, or disruptive emotionalism is detected."

    Will the BOP please respond to the following clarification questions automated termination of a visitation session:

    a. Mandatory vs. Optional Requirement: Please clarify whether automatic termination of visitation sessions based on detection of nudity, sexual behavior, or disruptive emotionalism is a mandatory requirement for all vendors. Additionally, please provide a definition of "disruptive emotionalism" that would necessitate the termination of a visitation session.

        Response: Yes, Disruptive emotionalism refers to a condition characterized by intense and often uncontrolled emotional responses that can significantly impact personal behavior and relationships. It involves a pattern of emotional dysregulation where an individual experiences mood swings, agitation, or heightened emotional responses that disrupt everyday functioning and interactions.

b. Detection Methodology: Is the detection of prohibited behavior expected to be performed through automated technologies (e.g., AI/computer vision, audio analysis), rule-based logic, or human moderation?

Response: Automated technologies.

c. Accuracy and False Positives: Are there minimum accuracy thresholds or acceptable false-positive rates for automated termination, and how should vendors address erroneous session terminations?

Response: A minimum accuracy rate of 95% is required. Regularly update the AI models with diverse datasets to minimize false positives.

d. Human Review and Override: Must the system allow authorized staff to review, override, or reinstate sessions that are automatically terminated, and is post-termination review required?

Response: Yes, the system should provide for authorized staff to review, override, and reinstate sessions that are automatically terminated. Yes, post termination review is required.

e. Privacy and Legal Considerations: Are there specific legal, privacy, or policy constraints that apply to automated behavioral monitoring and termination of video visitation sessions?

Response: The FBOP will provide the awardee with the proper documentation to implement appropriate legal and privacy protocols for automated behavioral monitoring.

f. Notification Requirements: Are automated notifications required to be sent to inmates, visitors, or staff when a session is terminated, and if so, what information must be included?"

Response: Yes, "Inmate - Your visiting session was terminated unexpectedly due to an inappropriate behavior report." "Visitors – Your visiting session was terminated unexpectedly due to an inappropriate behavior report." "Staff – The virtual session with [Inmates Name] and [Visitors Name] was terminated unexpectedly due to an inappropriate behavior report – review is required."

79. Will the BOP please provide respond to the following clarification questions regarding Statement of Objectives (SOO), section "6.1.2.13 Digital Law Library":

a. Please define the content scope of the Digital Law Library, including whether it must contain federal statutes, federal case law, and state-specific statutes/case law for each of the 120+ facilities.

   Response: The FBOP currently has a vendor that supports the law library. The intent is to have that vendor provide a URL that will give the inmate access to the content.

b. Will state-specific materials be tied to the facility's location, or must they be universally available across all institutions?

   Response: The FBOP currently has a vendor that supports the law library. The intent is to have that vendor provide a URL that will give the inmate access to the content.

c. What Digital Law Library is currently utilized by the BOP?

   Response: Lexis Nexis

80. After the first round of questions is answered, will the BOP accept additional questions if clarification is needed for any of the BOP's responses?

    Response: A second round of questions is due 2/23/2026.

81. General Question For projects like this, site surveys are usually carried out so that all vendors have accurate information for their quotes.

    a. Will these surveys happen as part of the RFP process, or only after an award is made?

       Response: The BOP is offering a site visit at Butner (2/18, 2/19) for up to three vendor representatives.

    b. Also, will you provide blueprints, floor plans, fire escape drawings, or schematics for each location so that vendors can accurately design the required wireless networks?

       Response: No.

82. Cover Letter, p.2 Given that the response to vendor questions may create additional critical questions, would the FBOP consider adding a second round of Questions and Answers so that vendors have all the answers they need to provide their best value proposal to the FBOP?

    Response: A second round of questions is due 2/23/2026.

83. Cover Letter, p.2

Questions are due Tuesday, 1/27, and proposals are due Thursday, 2/5. In practice, most vendors will need to finalize and upload their proposals by Wednesday, 2/4 to avoid submission risk. Even if FBOP responds to all questions by Friday, 1/30, vendors would have only four business days to incorporate the responses into their final proposals. To ensure that vendors have sufficient time to fully address FBOP's responses and submit their best-value proposals, will FBOP consider extending the proposal due date by at least four weeks from the date all questions are answered?

Response: The FBOP has extended the response deadline to 03/17/2026 at 12 PM EST.

84. Cover Letter, p.2 / RFP document, p.1

The due date for the response is noted as 5:00 pm EST (17:00 hours) on the Solicitation Offer and Award form on page 1, and by 2:00 pm EST on the Cover Letter. Will you confirm the correct deadline?

Response: The FBOP has extended the response deadline to 03/17/2026 at 12 PM EST.

85. RFP document, Section B, p.5 and 65

a. Will the FBOP accept proposals where the vendor charges the FBOP for the implementation of the Inmate Use Tablet program?

   Item #0001 suggests that vendors may quote a price per facility for the Inmate Use Tablet Implementation, but B.1, p.65, states, "The FBOP does not intend to directly pay for the tablets or the infrastructure they will operate on. The offeror will recoup these costs through the sale of services to the inmate/Trust Fund."

   Similarly, it appears that line items #0034 - 0046 would also be things that the FBOP would pay for if the vendor chooses to charge for them.

   Response: FBOP does not intend there to be a cost associated with CLIN #0001. The other line items may be priced as the vendor sees fit.

b. For item 0035, books and magazines, does the FBOP intend for this to be a charge to the inmate or is the FBOP looking for a program that will be free to the inmates and paid for by the FBOP?

   Response: FBOP welcomes a free basic application as well as offering a premium paid version that is paid for by the inmate.

86. RFP document, Section B, p.5

a. Would the FBOP please provide the actual number of transactions for the last 12 months for external electronic mail, video calling, phone calls, printing, and MP3 downloads?

   Response: The figures shown in Section B represent approximate usage over a one-year period. However, the video service is currently limited to institutions that house females, and the number provided reflects projected usage if the service is expanded across all institutions

b. Will the FBOP allow inmates to make phone calls directly from their tablets?

   Response: Social telephone calls are a required service for this initiative.

c. To give the FBOP the maximum choice in the evaluation of rates, will vendors be permitted to submit more than one copy of Section B and more than one financial narrative to explain the offers? This would allow vendors to present the FBOP with multiple pricing options. For example, a vendor may submit one proposal with higher costs for item 0001 and lower rates for the rates for services and another proposal where the cost for 0001 is minimal and the capital and expenses to deploy this project are subsidized in the rates for the services.

   Response: No. Vendors should complete a single Section B as described in the solicitation.

d. If a vendor charges any fees, such as a deposit fee for entertainment and messaging (applicable to either inmates or their friends and family), tablet infrastructure fees, or charges associated with converting a community tablet to an assigned tablet with access to paid content, where should these fees be documented?

   Response: All fees should be included in the Section B pricing schedule. Tablets will be issued to individual inmates. Community tablets are not being sought.

87. RFP, Section B, Item 0042, p.11

Would the FBOP please list the current vendors, along with their contact information, for the Inmate Trust Software, Inmate Banking/Accounting Software, Commissary Ordering Software, and the Offender Management System?

Response: The current inmate banking system is provided by Advanced Technologies Group (ATG).

Offender Management System: BOP utilizes an internally developed application called SENTRY. There is no vendor POC information for this system and the tablet initiative will not be connected to the system.

88. RFP, Section L.5, p.149 For the Technical Proposal response, does FBOP prefer that vendors:

    a. Embed their responses directly within the relevant sections of the Statement of Objectives (SOO), or

    b. Submit a separate, narrative technical proposal that references the SOO requirements?

    Response: Vendors shall respond in the form of a Performance Work Statement (PWS). Embedded responses will not be considered.

89. RFP, Section M.1, p.152 This section states that the FBOP anticipates awarding one contract for the services.

    a. For phone calling, will the awarded bidder process, terminate, and bill for all inmate phone calls whether they are by wall phone or tablet and for all call types (i.e., Debit, Prepaid, and Direct Bill)?

    Response: Social telephone calls are a required service for this initiative.

    b. Will the vendor invoice the FBOP for the actual minutes of use for all of these call types or will any be invoiced at a flat monthly rate?

    Response: The expectation is that the Bureau of Prisons will be billed for actual minutes used.

90. RFP, Section M.2, p.153 This section states that Price might contribute substantially to the Source Selection Official's (SSO's) contract award decision.

    Would the FBOP please provide the formula that will be used to combine the score for Price with the scores for Technical and Past Performance?

    Response: Proposals will be evaluated as stated in Section M. As the evaluation of competing offeror proposals in the Technical and Past Performance areas become more equal in rating, the more important Price will become in selecting the best value for the Government.

    This section states that the scores for Technical and Past Performance are equal but does not provide the formula to explain how Price will be combined with those to reach a final score for each vendor.

    Response: Proposals will be evaluated as stated in Section M. As the evaluation of competing offeror proposals in the Technical and Past Performance areas become more equal in rating, the more important Price will become in selecting the best value for the Government.

91. RFP, Section M.2, p.155 Subsection 3.0, Price Evaluation, states that the Contracting Officer (CO) will evaluate price and that it shall be inclusive of options.

    a. How will the CO mathematically evaluate the unit prices offered between vendors in Section B?

       Response: Pricing will be evaluated in total, inclusive of all option periods.

    b. Will the evaluation simply be the sum of the "Amount" for all line items compared and prorated between vendors?

       Response: The sum will be calculated for each line item at the estimated quantity listed in Section B, inclusive of all option periods, and added together for the total proposal price.

    c. If yes, will there be a weighting applied to each line item, or will each line simply be calculated as price * quantity and then summed to a total?

       Response: 39% Entertainment, 16% E-mail, 37% Phone, 7% Video Call, 1% Printing

    d. If a weighting will be applied, what will be the weight for each line item? The mathematical calculation for "Amount" (price * quantity) for lines 0001 through 0005 will be significantly higher than that for the other line items because only lines 0001 - 0005 contain actual unit quantities.

       Response: 39% Entertainment, 16% E-mail, 37% Phone, 7% Video Call, 1% Printing

    e. How will the prices for years 2 through 7.5 be used in the evaluation? For example, vendors may have upfront costs quoted for item 0001 in year 1, but those costs may be lower in years 2 through 7.5.

       Response: Pricing will be evaluated in total and inclusive of all option periods. Unbalanced pricing may increase proposal risk.

    f. How will the cost for the optional items be included in the evaluation of price?

       Response: Optional items will not be included in the price evaluation.

92. Attachment 4, Subcontracting Plan, p.1

    How will the Government evaluate the Small Business Subcontracting Plan?

    a. Will the Plan be assessed on a Pass/Fail basis, or will the Government assign an adjectival rating to the Plan? For example, if a bidder does not meet every one of

the subcontracting percentages, will their subcontracting plan fail and result in disqualification?

Response: The plan will be evaluated on a Pass/Fail basis. Not meeting an individual subcontracting percentage will not lead to failure. The plan is evaluated in whole.

b. If ratings are used, what criteria will determine those ratings?

Response: Ratings are not being used.

c. Regarding the Bureau Subcontracting Goals, please confirm that the 36% Small Business goal is based on Total Subcontracted Dollars and not based on total revenue generated by the contract.

Response: The goal of 36% is based on the Total Subcontracted Dollars not the total revenue generated.

d. Regarding the Subcontracting Plan, Principal Supplies/Services to Be Subcontracted, please confirm if specific subcontractor partners should be identified in the form, or if offerors should just identify the planned services/products to be subcontracted for each category.

Response: The vendor should list the Supplies/Services, not the subcontractor partner.

93. Attachment 11, Institution Address Addendum

a. Will the Satellite Facilities require wireless tablet infrastructure and all the same services as the Main facilities?

Response: Yes

b. If not, what services will be required at the satellite facilities?

Response: N/A

c. Is there a network connection between the main facility and the satellite facility? If so, is the vendor permitted to use it?

Response: No, existing raceways exist but we cannot verify that they can accept any new wiring if wiring cannot be installed in existing raceways due to issues or sizing new trenching must be conducted

d. Is the carrier DEMARC the same for both the Main facility and satellite facility or are there two sperate DEMARCs?

Response: Generally, they utilize the same DMARC (usually located in the main facility).

e. Will the main facility and satellite facility operate with the same inmate restrictions and time of use?

Response: Generally, yes but BOP requires the ability to adjust this individually.

94. Attachment 11, Institution Address Addendum

a. So that vendors may accurately estimate costs, would the FBOP please provide a list of each facility's housing unit name/location, number of beds and inmates, and layout (e.g., two-tier, linear, dormitory) where tablets will be used?

Response: Please reference the Population attachment.

b. Also, specify which visitation, education, medical, psychology, religious, and recreational spaces FBOP wants to equip with tablets.

Response: Each facility has these spaces in varying sizes as each institution is bespoke in layout and size

95. Attachment 12, SOO, 2, p.5

a. Will the winning vendor be required to provide its own telco circuits at each site to support phone calling, video calling, and tablet services or will the vendor use the FBOP's circuits?

Response: Yes

b. Section 1.1.3 of the RFP states, "Submission of interoperability test results and certifications validating device compatibility with DOJ enterprise infrastructure." What is the DOJ infrastructure that is referenced here?

Response: Currently there is no specified DOJ enterprise infrastructure designated at this time. When that infrastructure is designated, interoperability tests and compatibility certifications will be required.

c. Will the winning bidder be required to provide dedicated on-site support for these services at all or some of these facilities?

Response: Vendors should propose support models to meet SLA requirements

96. Attachment 12, SOO, 3, p.5 How many full-time dedicated staff are provided today by the current vendors for inmate phone calls, video calls, and the TRULINCS program?

Response: Inmate phone, video, and TRULINCS services are supported mainly by BOP staff, with supplemental vendor maintenance support. Exact staffing numbers are unavailable.

97. Attachment 12, SOO 3, p. 6. (a) The requirement states "Align backup and restore procedures with FBOP continuity of operations (COOP) policies." Can FBOP provide the COOP policies?

    Response: All systems, including file servers, application servers, domain controllers, and other critical infrastructure, will follow a standardized backup schedule aligned with system requirements and records retention policies. New systems will begin with a full backup, followed by incremental backups. A synthetic full backup will be performed every 14 days or when retention requirements change. Backup retention will not exceed 30 days unless a detailed request is submitted to the CIO and approved.

    a. The requirement states "Maintain full data retention, privacy, and records management compliance with OPCL and NARA requirements." Can the FBOP provide the OPCL and NARA requirements?

       Response: The use of a tablet would generate a new record category for FBOP. A record schedule would be submitted to capture the new record type that is generated. Currently inmates have limited email usage. For example, those records are maintained for 180 days (NARA schedule, N1-129-08-06). A new schedule would be written to capture the data elements the tablet would generate.

98. Attachment 12, SOO, 5.2.1.1, p.8

    This section specifies that the tablet must not include an external speaker. Would the FBOP consider a solution in which the speaker hardware is physically present but rendered non-functional through operating system/firmware controls enforced at the system level and inaccessible to the inmates?

    Response: FBOP would prefer that no external speaker be in the tablet, but if the vendor can specify how they are able to disable this speaker to the level that it cannot be re-enabled from the tablet device, this would meet the spirit of this requirement.

99. Attachment 12, SOO, 5.2.1.1, p.8

    a. For the requirement that staff be able to locate or track tablets remotely, including through metal or steel doors, does FBOP have a preferred or expected technical approach or solution?

       Response: FBOP welcomes the vendor's proposal to meet this requirement to have the ability to track and locate inmate tablet devices.

b. Would current industry solutions, such as location based on last network access point or the use of dedicated hardware (e.g., RFID) to locate powered-down devices, satisfy this requirement?

Response: The requirement is for the system to locate a device even when it is powered down.

100. Attachment 12, SOO, 5.2.1.1, p.9

a. For the requirement that the tablet not have USB connections user accessible, would the FBOP accept a solution where the port is covered by the case, disabled through software, and only usable with the correct ADB driver and security key? Most, if not all vendors, use some type of data port to load the initial software image on the tablets.

Response: Yes, FBOP would accept this.

101. Attachment 12, SOO, 5.2.1.2, p.9

This requirement states that vendors shall provide kiosks.

a. Do the FBOP facilities already have inpod kiosks? If yes, is the vendor able to utilize that same wiring and conduit?

Response: No

b. If a vendor can deliver all required services via inmate tablets, would kiosks still be required?

Response: Yes

c. If yes, what services must be supported on kiosks, and is there a required quantity or ratio of kiosks to be provided (e.g., one per housing unit)?

Response: Kiosks are intended to provide similar but limited functionality (as needed by BOP) as the tablet devices in cases where a tablet is damaged and awaiting a replacement or an inmate is prohibited from being issued a tablet.

102. Attachment 12, SOO, 5.2.1.2, p.9

If the only requirement for kiosks is for video visitation, in lieu of fixed wall-mounted video visitation terminals that occupy considerable wall space, would the FBOP be open to considering alternative solutions, such as secure wall-mounted docking stations designed for tablets?

These docking stations utilize near field communication (NFC) to connect with the tablets, enabling the camera to function for video visits while docked. Should the tablet be removed from the dock during a session, the video portion of the call would end while the audio portion would continue like a standard phone call.

Response: Kiosks are intended to provide similar but limited functionality (as needed by BOP) as the tablet devices in cases where a tablet is damaged and awaiting a replacement or an inmate is prohibited from being issued a tablet.

103. Attachment 12, SOO, 5.2.2, p.10

    a. In facilities where inmates have electrical outlets for in-cell power, will FBOP allow the use of individual transparent see-through chargers for the tablets? This will improve the user experience by allowing the inmates to charge their tablets while using them, providing longer run time and greater access to programs, education, and the inmate services.

       Response: Individual chargers for inmate tablets are not authorized for this solution.

    b. If so, would FBOP provide a list of facilities with in-cell power to help vendors accurately estimate charger quantities versus shared charging solutions?

       Response: Individual chargers for inmate tablets are not authorized for this solution.

104. Attachment 12, SOO, 5.2.2, p.10

    a. Do any of the FBOP facilities already have wireless access points installed for the inmate tablets?

       Response: FBOP utilizes Wireless access points for other devices, but none for inmate tablet devices

    b. If yes, which facilities and how many access points are live?

       Response: N/A

105. Attachment 12, SOO, 6.1.2, p.12

This section requires vendors to provide their most current System Security Plan ("SSP") and Security Assessment Report ("SAR"). Are these plans due to the FBOP Contracting Officer with the response to this RFP or are they due after contract award?

Response: It will be due after contract award.

106. Attachment 12, SOO, 6.1.2.1, p.13

a. For inmate commissary ordering via the tablet, please confirm that vendors simply provide access to FBOP's existing commissary system (e.g. commissary vendor provided URL), or is the vendor expected to provide a complete ordering, inventory, and spending-limit management solution?

Response: Access to FBOP's existing commissary system

b. What hardware and software do inmates use to order commissary today?

Response: None

c. What software is used for inventory management for limits on quantities, costs, restrictions, etc.?

Response: TRUFACS

107. Attachment 12, SOO, 6.1.2.4, p.13

This states 'Users shall be able to receive, access and display their personal digital scanned mail from the FBOP's designated provider.'

a. Please clarify whether this requirement is intended to support access to historical digitally scanned mail (1) on inmate tablets, (2) within a staff-facing user interface, or (3) both?

Response: Currently the BOP does not have a Digital Mail scanning service provider, but it reserves the ability to deliver scanned mail if/when a vendor is contracted.

b. Is the vendor required to import any existing historical scanned mail for viewing on the tablet?

Response: N/A

c. Who is FBOP's designated provider for mail scanning and would the FBOP provide a brief description on where and how the mail is scanned and stored today?

Response: N/A

108. Attachment 12, SOO, 6.1.2.5, p.13

a. What will happen to the existing MP3 players and purchased music when the new tablet contract is implemented? Will they be put into personal property and

available to the inmates upon release or will the inmates be allowed to continue to use them?

Response: To be determined

b. If the inmates will be able to continue to use them, will the inmates be permitted to have both their MP3 player and a tablet and how would the MP3 players be supported going forward?

Response: To be determined

c. Will the FBOP please provide the number of MP3 players currently in circulation and the number of MP3s on those players?

Response: There are currently 199,150 MP3 devices in circulation. The number of MP3's or media varies because inmates have the option to transfer media from their MP3 device to tablets.

109. Attachment 12, SOO, 6.1.2.5, p.14

In the first bullet on p.14, it says that Trust Fund shall apply an administrative markup to applicable items sold. On page 38 of the Trust Fund/Deposit Fund Manual, it shows mark-ups in the range of zero to 30-40%.

a. What are the current rates for External Electronic Mail, Video Calling, Phone calls, Printing, and MP3 downloads?

Response: The BOP is seeking the vendors best pricing for the contract line items in section B of the solicitation. Per Section B.1:

The vendor shall provide services directly to the Bureau of Prisons (BOP) and shall invoice the BOP monthly for services based on actual usage in accordance with the contract pricing schedule. BOP, as the sole authorized provider for the sale of items to the inmate population, shall apply an administrative markup to applicable items sold.

b. Would the FBOP please state what that markup will be and on what services?

Response: The BOP is seeking the vendors best pricing for the contract line items in section B of the solicitation. Per Section B.1:

The vendor shall provide services directly to the Bureau of Prisons (BOP) and shall invoice the BOP monthly for services based on actual usage in accordance with the contract pricing schedule. BOP, as the sole authorized provider for the

sale of items to the inmate population, shall apply an administrative markup to applicable items sold.

c. For example, does the FBOP envision marking up the prices for all items in Section B of the RFP document, to include External Electronic Mail, Video Calling, Phone Calls, Printing, and the rest of the items in Section B? This is critical for vendors to estimate the revenue that will be generated from their services to support the capital and operating expenses (opex) required in this project. As the markup increases, demand will be suppressed and revenue to the vendor will decline, impacting the vendors' return on investment (ROI) and return on invested capital.

   Response: The BOP is seeking the vendors best pricing for the contract line items in section B of the solicitation. Per Section B.1:

   The vendor shall provide services directly to the Bureau of Prisons (BOP) and shall invoice the BOP monthly for services based on actual usage in accordance with the contract pricing schedule. BOP, as the sole authorized provider for the sale of items to the inmate population, shall apply an administrative markup to applicable items sold.

110. Attachment 12, SOO, 6.1.2.6, p.14

a. For how long are vendors required to store social and professional visit detail records?

   Response: Records detailing inmate visits will be maintained for five years after the date of the visit.

b. For how long are vendors required to store social visit recordings?

   Response: Social visiting records to be maintained for 180 days, or longer, if needed for mission related purposes

c. For how long are vendors required to store the text transcriptions of social visits?

   Response: Text transcriptions of social visits are to be maintained for 180 days, or longer, if needed for mission related purposes.

d. Can the FBOP please clarify if the location-based security is for the inmate or visitor?

   Response: There should be the capability to geo fence and restrict call locations for inmates to specific areas within the institution, as well as restrict specific time frames. This requirement is for inmates.

111. Attachment 12, SOO, 6.1.2.6, p.15

Does FBOP intend for the visitors' video calls to be conducted at a designated area at a FBOP facility as an onsite video call? Or is the intention of the FBOP that these visitors' video calls are going to be held at a separate visitor center? If the answer is at a visitor center, is the FBOP going to provide this physical visitor center?

Response: Video calls to visitors off BOP property.

112. Attachment 12, SOO, 6.1.2.7, p.16

This section mentions a digital library service, with access to educational materials. Would the FBOP provide details on what is contained in the "digital library service"?

Response: A digital library service should have the ability to offer periodicals and reference materials like a standalone library. We would also like the ability to enhance our outside library service offerings by having the ability for inmates to check out books and have them returned at the end of the duration, much in the same way that an interlibrary loan service would operate.

113. Attachment 12, SOO, 6.1.2.7, p.16

This section states, "The devices shall be configured to stream FBOP provided lessons via provided URL…" and "The devices shall allow access to FBOP approved URL's…" Would the FBOP please confirm that the URLs are specifically designed for corrections (correctionsgrade, i.e., no external links, contact us, etc.)? Would the FBOP provide vendors with the URLs now so vendors may test them against the vendor's security standards?

Response: The URLs would link to BOP approved web-sites that have been tailored for BOP use and URLs may be added or removed to this list as required

114. Attachment 12, SOO, 6.1.2.10, p.17

a. For how long are vendors required to store video relay service call detail records?

   Response: Per RIDS, N1-129-05-16, Trust Fund, Telephone Monitoring Systems, 1. Inmate Telephone System (ITS) c. Data. Inmate telephone call data records, ITS transactions and balances. Disposition: Temporary. Archive annually in ITS when records are 9 years old. Delete annually 10 years after archiving or when no longer needed for legal or administrative purposes, whichever is later.

b. For how long are vendors required to store video relay service call recordings?

Response: Per RIDS, N1-129-05-16, Trust Fund, Telephone Monitoring Systems, 2. Inmate Trust Fund Digital Recorder (INTRUDR) c. Data. Call recordings, call data information, call monitoring information. Disposition: Temporary. Deleted in the system after 180 days or when no longer needed for legal or administrative purposes, whichever is later.

c. For how long are vendors required to store the text transcriptions of video relay service calls?

Response: Per RIDS, N1-129-05-16, Trust Fund, Telephone Monitoring Systems, 2. Inmate Trust Fund Digital Recorder (INTRUDR) c. Data. Call recordings, call data information, call monitoring information. Disposition: Temporary. Deleted in the system after 180 days or when no longer needed for legal or administrative purposes, whichever is later.

115. Attachment 12, SOO, 6.1.2.11, p.18

a. For how long are vendors required to store phone call detail records?

Response: Call details records would be maintained for 180 days, or longer, if needed for mission related purposes.

b. For how long are vendors required to store phone call recordings?

Response: Phone call recordings would be maintained for 180 days, or longer, if needed for mission related purposes.

c. For how long are vendors required to store the text transcriptions of phone calls?

Response: Text Transcriptions would be maintained for 180 days, or longer, if needed for mission related purposes.

116. Attachment 12, SOO, 6.1.2.11, p.18

Bullet #4 states, "solution shall be able to interface and communicate with the current inmate financial services platform."

a. Would the FBOP please describe any interfaces and communications that are in place today and will be required going forward, as well as any new interfaces and communications that are known to be required?

Response: The integration method will be defined jointly by service provider and the selected vendor.

b. Would the FBOP please provide any sample files that are available for the existing interfaces related to inmate calls and their TRUFONE account?

Response: Access to this information is restricted until a formal contract has been finalized and officially awarded.

117. Attachment 12, SOO, 6.1.2.11, p.18

Bullet #6 speaks to the purchase of credits via the Inmate Financial System or through the transfer of funds to an external ITS account.

Section 6.5 of the Trust Fund/Deposit Fund Manual provides some explanation of how the existing TRUFONE account works but does not cover how the following requirement is met today, "The ITS shall verify the availability of sufficient phone account funds prior to call initiation, deduct applicable charges during call progression, and immediately post final charges upon call completion. Under no circumstances shall the system permit a negative phone account balance."

a. Would the FBOP please explain how this works today, if that is how the FBOP expects it to work going forward, and if not, what is the new expectation? We have the same questions for the rest of the services listed in Section B of the RFP.

Response: Funds will not be transferred directly from an inmate's trust account to the vendor's financial institution or bank. Inmate funds are held in a single Treasury consolidated account, and the vendor's system will hold funds for tracking purposes only, without depositing them into any personal or external account. The Bureau of Prisons will pay actual cost of services, ensuring compliance with Treasury law by maintaining proper oversight, accountability, and protection of public funds.

b. How will the inmates set aside their trust fund dollars to pay for those services and how will the vendor ensure that the inmates have the funds available for the services they are using in each month?

Response: All calling funds will be transferred from the Inmate Financial System to an external ITS system designated for phone service. The vendor's system will hold funds for tracking purposes only, without depositing them into any personal or external account.

c. Will any of the services be prepaid where the inmate must buy credits in advance of using the services?

Response: Yes, inmates may be able to purchase credits in advance; however, those credits will be maintained within the vendor system for tracking and usage management purposes only and will not represent

funds transferred to or held in external or vendor financial account. All inmate funds will remain within the Treasury consolidated account. Actual service usage will be billed to the Bureau of Prisons, and the Bureau of Prisons will pay the actual cost of services in compliance with Treasury requirements.

d. If yes, how will the vendor accomplish that in partnership with the Inmate Financial System?

Response: The integration method will be defined jointly by service provider and the selected vendor.

118. Attachment 12, SOO, 6.1.2.11, p.19

Bullet #3 mentions communication controls and Program Statement P5264.08 speaks to some of the call controls established in 2008.

a. Would the FBOP please provide any calling restrictions that are in place today, and will be going forward?

Response: Phones can be limited due to security related reasons.

b. For example, will inmates be limited to just 300 calling minutes per inmate per month?

Response: Currently inmates are limited to 510 minutes per month.

119. Attachment 12, SOO, 6.1.2.12, p.19

a. Will the Electronic Mail Messaging solution covered in this RFP replace the email functionality within TRULINCS described in Chapter 14 of Program Statement P4500.12, or will inmates still have the ability to send email through TRULINCS?

Response: The outcome will be based on the vendor's submission and the award decision.

b. If inmates will still be able to send emails through TRULINCS, would the FBOP please explain what inmate access will be to that service so that vendors can adjust their expectations on revenue from Electronic Mail Messaging due to the competing service through TRULINCS?

Response: The outcome will be based on the vendor's submission and the award decision.

120. Attachment 12, SOO, 6.1.2.13, p.19

a. Will vendors be required to provide the license for digital law library or are vendors only required to provide access to FBOP's licensed law library provider?

   Response: The FBOP currently has a vendor that supports the law library. The intent is to have that vendor provide a URL that will give the inmate access to the content.

b. If vendors must provide the license, would FBOP please provide details on the license required and if there is a specific vendor that is preferred?

   Response: N/A - Vendor would not be required to provide licenses.

c. For example, how many individual licenses, or how many devices, will be covered?

   Response:N/A

d. Will an electronic license suffice or is there a requirement for a physical library as well?

   Response: The intent is to have the selected vendor provide access to a law library URL provided by the Law Library Vendor.

e. Are there any specific modules or other requirements for the content of the library?

   Response: N/A - Content for the Law Library is covered under another contract.

f. Who is the FBOP's current law library provider?

   Response: Lexis Nexis

121. Attachment 12, SOO, 6.1.3, p.19

a. Are bidders required to provide a price for every item on the cost sheet, to include the optional services?

   Response: Vendors must provide pricing for the required services. Pricing for the ancillary items are not required.

b. If not, how will total Price be evaluated between bidders that do provide a price for everything versus those that do not?

   Response: The ancillary items will not be part of the award evaluation.

122. Attachment 12, SOO, 6.1.3, p.19

a. Are vendors required to provide solutions for all the items listed in the optional services section?

   Response: Vendors are encouraged to provide pricing for each item but are not required to. The ancillary items will not be part of the award evaluation and will be reviewed separately.

b. if not, how will solutions for the optional services be evaluated between bidders that do provide a solution for everything versus those that do not?

   Response: The ancillary items will not be part of the award evaluation and will be reviewed separately.

123. Attachment 12, SOO, 6.1.3, p.19

a. Are vendors permitted to offer additional optional services not covered in this section?

   Response: Vendors may include additional no cost services in proposal submissions.

b. If yes, how should the bidder communicate those options (i.e., may bidders add rows to RFP Section B to insert the item(s) and price)?

   Response: No.

124. Attachment 12, SOO, 6.1.3.2, p.20

a. What Electronic Health Records (EHR) does the FBOP currently utilize?

   Response: BOP doesn't utilize a telehealth specific platform at this time. All video communications for telehealth presently utilize the Cisco Webex platform and internal video conferencing devices to connect to public telehealth providers, using their preferred internet connected device.

b. Is there a point of contact the FBOP can provide to vendors?

   Response: Not Currently.

125. Attachment 12, SOO, 6.4, p.24

In the section for subscription-based services, it mentions downloadable content. Most tablet providers have moved to a model where all content is streamed and very little is downloaded to the tablet. A key benefit to this approach is that all data is stored and

backed up in the cloud and should an inmate's tablet become unusable, they can be issued another and access their subscription services immediately.

a. Will the FBOP accept a model where all subscription content is streamed, and none is downloaded and stored locally on the tablets?

   Response: Yes FBOP will accept this model.

b. If not, what content must be downloadable?

   Response: N/A

126. Attachment 12, SOO, 7.13, p.30

The second bullet refers to the 'Infrastructure Installation Plan' and states technical documentation of wired and wireless infrastructure, including device configurations, network diagrams, and interoperability certifications with DOJ enterprise systems.

a. Is it correct that all the items listed in Section 7.13 are to be provided in accordance with the project schedule, after contract award?

   Response: Correct. After Award.

b. If not, which of these items are due with the proposal on 2/5?

   Response: N/A

127. Business Management Questionnaire, page 2, and RFP, Section L.4, page 149, and 3. Bank Reference Letter

The Business Management Questionnaire requests bank reference contact information. The RFP document, page 149, L.4. TPS Proposals states Volume II Business Proposals shall contain "Bank Reference Letters" and document 3. Bank Reference Letter provides a template for vendors to draft a letter for submittal to any bank reference. Will the FBOP clarify the instructions regarding the Bank Reference?

a. Do we need to provide a bank reference letter from our bank in Volume Two of our proposal, or just provide the details required in the Business Management Questionnaire?

   Response: The bank needs to be notified that member of the BOP may seek information regarding the vendors financial capability to perform under the terms of the contract. The Bank Notification Letter attachment is a template that may be used.

b. For the copy of our Bank Notification Letter, do vendors need to provide proof of letter submittal to our bank reference? If yes, will a copy of our email submittal to the bank suffice as evidence?

Response: Yes. An email will be sufficient.

128. RFP, Section H.1, Special Contract Requirements, p.71

The requirement states, "Within 18 months - The Cloud system must be evaluated by a Third-Party Assessing Organization ("3PAO") certified under FedRAMP; the Cloud system received FedRAMP high authorization; the Contractor has provided the most current System Security Plan ("SSP") and Security Assessment Report ("SAR") to the BOP CO for consideration." Will the FBOP confirm that the 18-month period begins after system implementation?

Response: The timeframe is dictated by your 3PAO contractor and working with the FedRAMP PMO office. Upon contract award the awardee is expected to build a solution in an approved GovCloud space. When the awardee has completed this process, they are then expected to hire an approved 3PAO. BOP's intent is to then sponsor the awardee for their FedRamp certification. While the vendor works to get the FedRamp Certification (to operate in GOV Cloud), BOP will issue an interim 12-month ATO.

129. Business Management Questionnaire

The Business Management Questionnaire requires vendors to "List the last three contracts awarded to your firm which are of a related nature…" Can FBOP confirm that contracts of a similar size and service will meet this requirement?

Response: Contracts of similar size and scope will be considered.

130. Will the Bureau provide an updated list of main and satellite facilities to include ADP by institution?

Response: See population attachment.

131. Could vendors possibly tour one satellite and one main facility to review cable and installation needs?

Response: The BOP is offering a site Visits at Butner (2/18, 2/19) for up to 3 vendor representatives.

132. Please provide the current rates paid by incarcerated individuals for phone calling.

Response: The BOP is seeking the vendors best pricing for the contract line items in section B of the solicitation. Per Section B.1:

The vendor shall provide services directly to the Bureau of Prisons (BOP) and shall invoice the BOP monthly for services based on actual usage in accordance with the contract pricing schedule. BOP, as the sole authorized provider for the sale of items to the inmate population, shall apply an administrative markup to applicable items sold.

133. Please provide the breakout of telephone usage by jurisdictions, i.e., local, intrastate, interstate, NANPA countries (Canada, P.R. USVI); and, other international.

Response: The BOP is seeking the vendors best pricing for the contract line items in section B of the solicitation. Per Section B.1:

The vendor shall provide services directly to the Bureau of Prisons (BOP) and shall invoice the BOP monthly for services based on actual usage in accordance with the contract pricing schedule. BOP, as the sole authorized provider for the sale of items to the inmate population, shall apply an administrative markup to applicable items sold.

134. Will phone calling on tablets be allowed?

Response: Social telephone calls are a required service for this initiative.

135. Will video communications via tablets be allowed?

Response: Video visitation is a required service for this initiative

136. Will a la carte media purchases be allowed (in addition to subscriptions)?

Response: The proposed content is streaming only.

137. Who does the FBOP use for healthcare needs/services for IIs today?

Response: Overall healthcare is provided by a combination of in-house care provided by BOP staff and contractors, as well as community care to include telehealth and specialist visits provided under the umbrella of comprehensive medical contracts.

138. How do IIs communicate their needs for healthcare services today?

Response: Currently they attend sick call-in person or submit paper sick call request forms during periods when there is no sick call within the health services department, such as lock downs. Additionally, they may submit electronic requests for staff forms for certain minor needs not requiring evaluation.

139. What vendor provides FBOP with the solution for Electronic Health Records today?

Response: Advanced Technologies Group (ATG)

140. What level of integration or types of data sharing is the agency looking for between the vendor and designated EHR solution?

Response: That's not fully known at this time but can be assumed to include at a minimum secure video conferencing with potential EHR integration to follow.

141. FedRAMP Timeline: Is the timeline for FedRamp certification 18 months from contract award date? We need to be clear that we will not start preparations until we know we have won. (page 71, Item H.1. Special Contract Requirements)

Response: Upon contract award the awardee is expected to build a solution in an approved GovCloud space. When the awardee has completed this process, they are then expected to hire an approved 3PAO. BOP's intent is to then sponsor the awardee for their FedRamp certification. While the vendor works to get the FedRamp Certification (to operate in GOV Cloud), BOP will issue an interim 12-month ATO.

142. FedRAMP Timeline: After the 18 month FedRamp certification period, can we then begin to pilot or will we be allowed to pilot during the build-out period? (page 71, Item H.1. Special Contract Requirements)

Response: Upon contract award the awardee is expected to build a solution in an approved GovCloud space. When the awardee has completed this process, they are then expected to hire an approved 3PAO. BOP's intent is to then sponsor the awardee for their FedRamp certification. While the vendor works to get the FedRamp Certification (to operate in GOV Cloud), BOP will issue an interim 12-month ATO.

143. FedRAMP: The SOO asks for services being provided to be hosted in a FedRAMP environment. Can internal business systems continue to operate in our current non-FedRAMP environment? (The SOO frequently states: pg 2, Executive Summary; pg 12, section 6.1.2 Services: "Hosting will reside exclusively in GovCloud environments, with mandatory FedRAMP High certification and full FISMA compliance." etc.)

Response: Internal business systems can operate outside the FedRAMP environment. The BOP instance, any internal systems that support the BOP contract, must be hosted in a FedRAMP environment.

144. When is FedRAMP compliance required after the award? Can vendors launch pilots using a non-FedRAMP environment?

Response: Upon contract award the awardee is expected to build a solution in an approved GovCloud space. When the awardee has completed this process, they are then expected to hire an approved 3PAO. BOP's intent is to then sponsor the awardee for their FedRamp certification. While the vendor works to get the FedRamp Certification (to operate in GOV Cloud), BOP will issue an interim 12-month ATO. We cannot exchange Govt information on a non-FedRAMP environment.

145. Patching and vulnerability management release: Is this for Critical and High vulnerabilities? What about Medium and Low vulnerabilities? What if the vulnerability in question does not have a remediation in place but it is just informational? What if the vulnerability requires additional testing and cannot be fixed in 14 days because the fix impacts production? Do we have the ability to communicate alternative timelines agreeable to both parties? (Page 154 of RFP, Section 1.2.2 subfactor of Security and Compliance)

    Response: We follow the DOJ and CISA guidance/policies on vulnerability patching. The expectation is to patch all vulnerabilities. We will discuss further with the awardee of the contract

146. Critical Vulnerabilities must be fixed within 24 hours. What if the remediation path impacts production and cannot be completed in that timeline? Is there a path to communicate alternate remediation paths while still focusing on getting the Critical and High vulns fixed? (SOO, page 6)

    Response: We follow the DOJ and CISA guidance/policies on vulnerability patching. The expectation is to patch all vulnerabilities. We will discuss further with the awardee of the contract.

147. Do AI models have to show certification/adherence/evidence to follow specific NIST requirements? (SOO, page 21, section 6.1.3.4, for example)

    Response: All AI models require DOJ approval.

148. Is HIPAA compliance required as a part of the Telehealth apps that we will be running? Does the customer expect us to provide that level of certification? (Telehealth apps are mentioned in various places throughout SOO, and in the first 71 pages of the RFP, under telehealth services. However, HIPAA compliance is never brought up.)

    Response: Federal HIPPA requirement for telehealth records necessitate that all Electronic Protected Health Information (ePHI) created, stored, or transmitted during virtual visits remain secure, encrypted, and private.
    Vendors must use HIPPA-compliant platforms with Business Associated Agreements - BAAs, maintain strict access controls, conduct risk analyses, and allow patient access to records

149. Retention Period: For FBOP. How long should audio and video call recordings be stored?

    Response: Phone and video call recordings would be maintained for 180 days, or longer, if needed for mission related purposes.

150. Retention Policy/Period: What is the retention policy for email communications?

Response: Email Communication should be maintained for 180 days, or longer, if needed for mission related purposes.

151. Security Incidents: Does the customer need to be involved in all levels of security incidents or just Critical and High related ones? (ref: Pg 73: Sections K and L, with their definitions of "Security Breach" and "Security Incident". Also, page 78 of RFP, Section VI. Information System Security Incident)

    Response: Yes, the DOJ and the BOP will be involved in all levels of security incidents.

152. System design changes: We need clarification to this question: Changes to system design must be updated through the authorization process per NIST SP 800-37 Revision 2, Step 6 ('Continuous Monitoring") or current NIST revision. (page 76 of RFP, item 21.)

    Response: The Configuration Management process must be adhered to, that is part of continuous monitoring. There is an approval process of Configuration Changes

153. Employees and Contractors: We need clarification of where non-US citizens can be involved in supporting the FedRamp environment? (page 80 of RFP, section called "DOJ-07"; page 128 of RFP, section "DOJ-03 Personnel Security Requirements"; SOO, page 28, DOJ Order 0904 and DOJ-003, and SOO, page 28, about residency requirements)

    Response: Non-U.S citizens are not authorized to access DOJ information technology (IT) systems or assist in the development, operation, management, or maintenance of DOJ IT systems, including providing IT system support, unless a waiver has been granted by the Head of the DOJ component or designee, with the prior concurrence of both the DSO and the DOJ Chief Information Officer, allowing computer access by the non-U.S. citizen. Such a waiver will be granted only in exceptional and unique circumstances on a case-by-case basis. It should be noted that the Justice Consolidated Office Network (JCON) is a sensitive DOJ IT system and any contractor employee who will need access to JCON must be a U.S. citizen or have received a In order for a waiver to be considered for approval: (1) There must be a compelling reason for using this individual as opposed to a U.S. citizen; (2) The type of personnel security vetting that has been conducted on the individual, and vetting results, that would mitigate risk; and (3) The waiver must be in the best interest of the federal government. The Department of Justice does not permit the use of Non-U.S. citizens in the performance of this contract or commitment for any position that involves access to or development of any DOJ IT system. By signing the contract or commitment document, the contractor agrees to this restriction. In those instances where other non-IT requirements contained in the contract or commitment can be met by using Non-U.S. citizens, those requirements shall be clearly described.

154. 5.1.2. - Would the Bureau consider allowing one site survey at each type of facility to allow a better understanding of the cabling needs?

Response: The BOP is offering a site Visits at Butner (2/18, 2/19) for up to 3 vendor representatives.

155. What is the process of introducing system innovation & upgrades (e.g., new system for existing functionality) during the contract?

Response: Working with BOP stakeholders, we will use the Configuration Management Process.

156. Are audio translation services meant to cover phone calls or support live peer-to-peer conversation, using a tablet as a translation device, or both?

Response: Both.

157. Does FBOP require a specific location for digital mail to be scanned?

Response: Currently the BOP does not have a Digital Mail scanning service provider, but it reserves the ability to deliver scanned mail if/when a vendor is contracted. The optional CLIN is for providing this service.

158. We have interpreted different inmate payment processing methods. It seems that for all inmate paid services, aside from ITS, we are to deduct from the inmate trust account. For ITS, we are not to deduct directly from the trust account. Our system has a banking system that adequately integrates with the trust account to allow inmates to move funds from their trust account to their vendor account. What is the purpose behind these FBOP requesting these different processes?

Response: Funds will not be transferred directly from an inmate's trust account to the vendor's financial institution or bank. Inmate funds are held in a single Treasury consolidated account, and the vendor's system will hold funds for tracking purposes only, without depositing them into any personal or external account. The Bureau of Prisons will pay actual cost of services, ensuring compliance with Treasury law by maintaining proper oversight, accountability, and protection of public funds.

159. What is the current per-minute cost of calling

Response: The BOP is seeking the vendors best pricing for the contract line items in section B of the solicitation. Per Section B.1:

The vendor shall provide services directly to the Bureau of Prisons (BOP) and shall invoice the BOP monthly for services based on actual usage in accordance with the contract pricing schedule. BOP, as the sole authorized provider for the sale of items to the inmate population, shall apply an administrative markup to applicable items sold.

160. Was this impacted by FCC Orders in 2025?

Response: Yes

161. If so, please provide both "Before" and "After" FCC rates.

Response: The BOP is seeking the vendors best pricing for the contract line items in section B of the solicitation. Per Section B.1:

The vendor shall provide services directly to the Bureau of Prisons (BOP) and shall invoice the BOP monthly for services based on actual usage in accordance with the contract pricing schedule. BOP, as the sole authorized provider for the sale of items to the inmate population, shall apply an administrative markup to applicable items sold.
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You provided a reference point in the RFP of 400M annual minutes. What period does this cover? (We need to model the pricing changes vs. minutes of usage.) What is the jurisdictional breakout of the minutes? (We need this to properly estimate taxes and regulatory fees.)

Local
Intrastate
Interstate – domestic
Interstate – NANPA (Canada, P.R., USVI)
Interstate – other international

Response: The BOP is seeking the vendors best pricing for the contract line items in section B of the solicitation. Per Section B.1:

The vendor shall provide services directly to the Bureau of Prisons (BOP) and shall invoice the BOP monthly for services based on actual usage in accordance with the contract pricing schedule. BOP, as the sole authorized provider for the sale of items to the inmate population, shall apply an administrative markup to applicable items sold.

162. What percentage of the incarcerated population are currently served by tablets?

Response: The percentage of incarcerated population with tablets varies. There are currently 127,136 tablets active.

163. What percentage of FBOP facilities currently have tablets available?

Response: All institutions have tablets available through the commissary.

164. Will tablet charging stations be required throughout; or, would there be the option of utilizing personalized A.C. adaptors in some or all of the facilities?

Response: Tablet charging stations are required, individual chargers for inmate use tablets are not authorized

165. What is the current price of email?

Response: The BOP is seeking the vendors best pricing for the contract line items in section B of the solicitation. Per Section B.1:

The vendor shall provide services directly to the Bureau of Prisons (BOP) and shall invoice the BOP monthly for services based on actual usage in accordance with the contract pricing schedule. BOP, as the sole authorized provider for the sale of items to the inmate population, shall apply an administrative markup to applicable items sold.

166. What percentage of incarcerated population has access to email?

Response: All inmates unless they have a restriction that does not permit them to utilize it.

167. If they do not have a personal tablet, how is this achieved?

Response: Inmate population currently uses TRULINCS inmate workstations messaging services.

168. What is the expected mark-up on services from the trust provider

Response: The Markup will be decided internally by the FBOP after award.

169. With the scope of the required response, would the FBOP consider an extension on the timeline for submission?

Response: The FBOP has extended the response deadline to 3/17/26 at 12pm EST.

170. Does the BOP require the contractor to provide all Network Hardware, ie Access Points, Switches, routers, cableing, etc. for this program?

Response: Yes

171. Regarding "infrastructure must be hardwired:" are cable and conduit pathways available at each BOP location for hardwire connection?

Response: In most cases no, some patchways may be available at some facilities. The vendor should be prepared to install cable and conduit and create patchways as needed (core drilling).

172. What clearances are required at the BOP for onsite work at BOP locations?

Response: Contractor employees working at a FBOP facility will be subject to a background investigation after award of the contract. Contractor employees must complete the applicable

forms provided by the FBOP Contracting Officer's Representative. Following the investigation, the FBOP will provide the Contractor with a list of employees approved to work at the institution. If a Contractor's employee is not approved, only that fact will be communicated to the Contractor. No additional justification will be released, in compliance with Privacy Act requirements.

173. The purpose of this initiative by FBOP as stated, in pertinent part, in the RFP is "...to design, deploy, and sustain a secure, scalable, and compliant digital services platform that will provide … equitable access to education, healthcare, legal, religious, and communication resources. The program's purpose is to enhance service delivery while maintaining strict adherence to federal IT security and accessibility standards."

    The RFP provides very detailed descriptions of how this service platform should operate and be delivered. Specifically, RFP Section 5.2 (Equipment Requirements) goes into very specific and minute detail regarding every facet of the physical makeup of tablets and kiosk hardware. These requirements obviously directly correlate to the need for the utmost physical security given the nature of the populations being housed within FBOP facilities.

    However, such minute and specific criteria operate to exclude nearly all, if not completely all, commercially available, state of the art tablet technology. The value and fidelity of any procurement necessitates robust competition to provide FBOP with a full picture of all possible means of providing the desired services while still meeting the needed security requirements.

    To that end, will FBOP consider hardware service options that provide the core of the services being sought within this RFP provided there are clear explanations illustrating how alternative hardware service methods still meet the needed security requirements of FBOP?

    Response: Yes, the BOP would consider this.

174. Part of the services being sought through this RFP is the expansion of network service/infrastructure throughout all FBOP facilities. This is to facilitate broader access to the use of tablets for communication and also programming. As the RFP is currently written, the awarded contractor will provide this network buildout and by extension be responsible for its oversight and maintenance throughout the course of the contract.

    To ensure that programming and services that can be hosted on this network are not limited by the contracted network provider, would FBOP consider adding a condition related to the network requirements indicating that the network provider will not limit or prohibit network access to other service providers that FBOP may want to utilize throughout its facilities?

Response: No